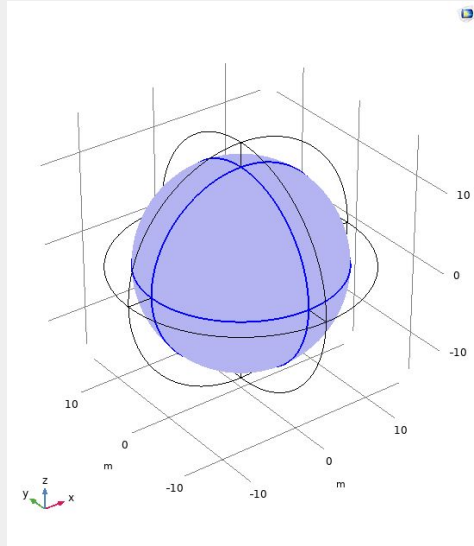
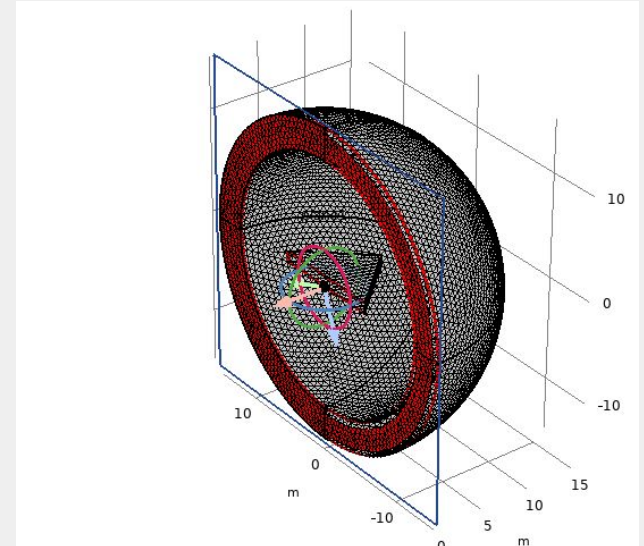
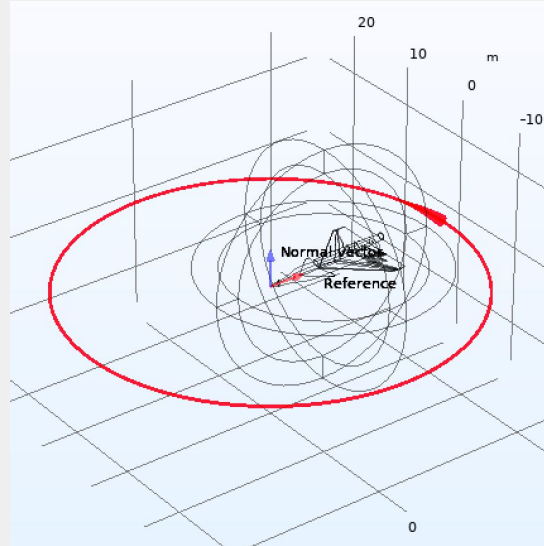


# RADAR field physics initialization



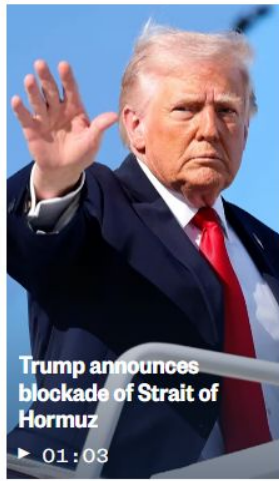
## Far-field domain

At sufficient distances, a point source of radio waves can be characterized as a plane wave



## Impedance boundary condition

At 100MHz, the skin depth of aluminum is on the order of  $1e-6$ , much less than its thickness



**13 April, 2026**

<https://www.nbcnews.com/middle-east-conflict>



**2 March, 2022**

<https://www.newyorker.com/news/annals-of-communications/a-mediated-view-of-the-war-in-ukraine>

At the 2025 NATO Summit in The Hague, Allies made a commitment to investing **5% of Gross Domestic Product** (GDP) annually on core defence requirements and defence- and security-related spending by 2035.

[Defense expenditure and NATO's 5% commitment](#)

Canada is investing more than **\$63 billion** in defence across the Department of National Defence (DND), the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF), and other government partners including military personnel, readiness, equipment, and infrastructure.

[Canada achieves the 2% of gross domestic product  
defense spending benchmark](#)



## Russo-Ukrainian war

Canada has committed over **\$25.5 billion** in multifaceted assistance for Ukraine .

[Economic, humanitarian and development assistance, and security and stabilization support – Russia’s invasion of Ukraine](#)

## Israeli-Palestinian conflict

Since the current conflict began, and with the additional resources announced in July 2025, Canada’s contributions now total more than **\$355 million**.

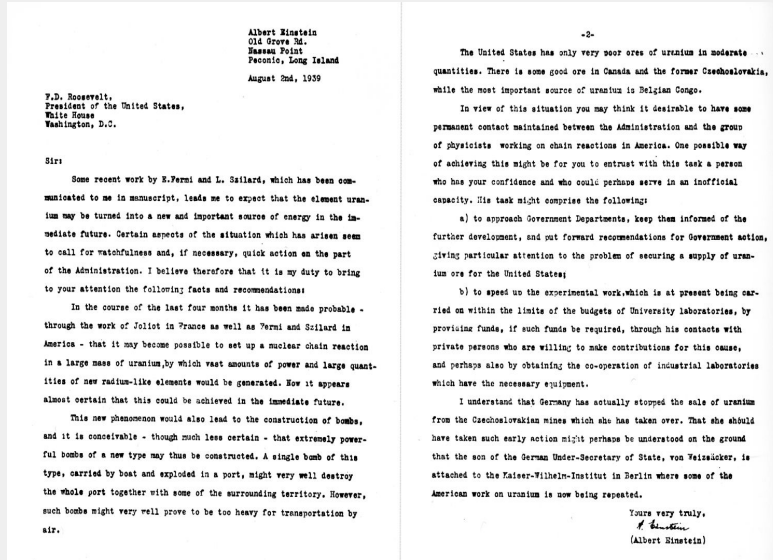
[Backgrounder: Canada’s International Assistance to the West Bank and Gaza](#)

## Israeli-Syrian conflict (during Syrian Civil War)

Since 2016, Canada has committed more than **\$4.7 billion** in funding for Syria and countries hosting Syrian refugee populations.

[Backgrounder: Canada announces measures and support for the people of Syria](#)





1939 letter by Einstein and Szilard urging  
Roosevelt to develop a nuclear program.

[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Einstein%E2%80%93Szilard\\_letter](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Einstein%E2%80%93Szilard_letter)

State-sponsored Manhattan Project to  
develop the atomic bomb

<https://www.construction-physics.com/p/an-engineering-history-of-the-manhattan>

# Stealth



Arctic fox camouflaged  
in snow

<https://manilastandard.net/?p=314271425>



Ninja in black clothing

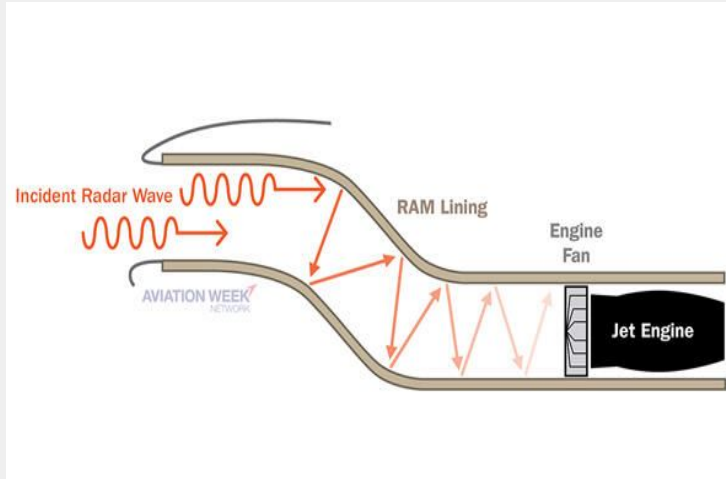
[https://www.historyskills.com/classroom/year-8/ninjas/?srsltid=AfmBOoo\\_xmGpO9fpdvBITijDDLbKLC7qEZB6dqq7Rh2JGSPz5x\\_UQtj](https://www.historyskills.com/classroom/year-8/ninjas/?srsltid=AfmBOoo_xmGpO9fpdvBITijDDLbKLC7qEZB6dqq7Rh2JGSPz5x_UQtj)



Ground squirrel chewing on  
snake skin to mask its scent

<https://twig.technology/blog/ground-squirrel-rattlesnake-deterrence>

# Factors of stealth seen in modern aircraft technology



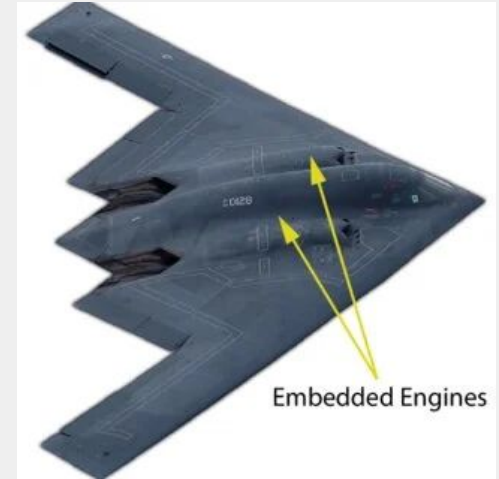
## Radiation-absorbent materials

<https://aviationweek.com/aerospace/aircraft-propulsion/magic-behind-radar-absorbing-materials-stealthy-aircraft>



## Camouflage

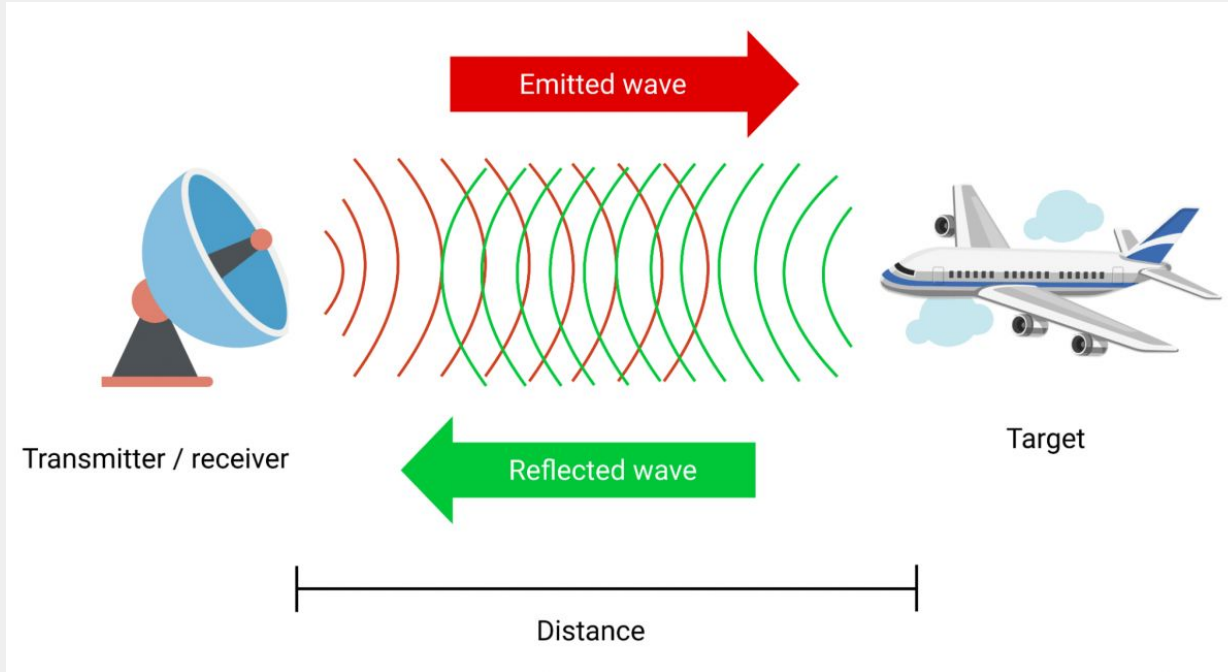
<https://www.defencexp.com/stealth-technology-how-aircraft-becomes-invisible/>



## Low acoustic signature

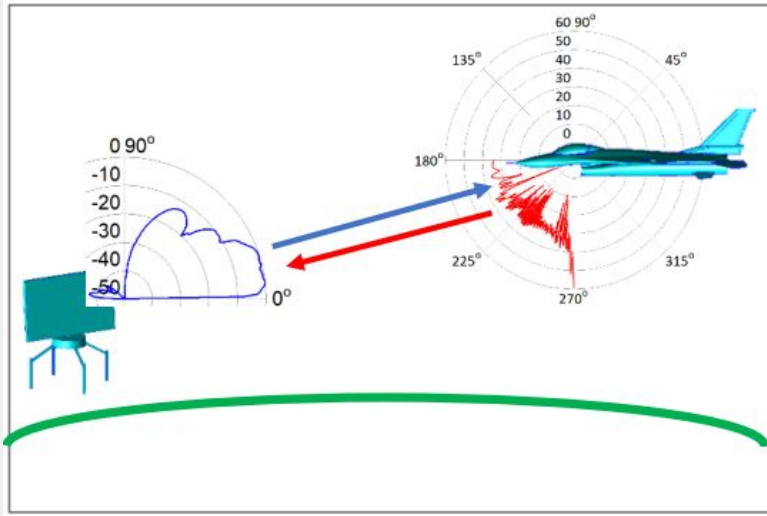
[https://www.researchgate.net/figure/B-2-Spirit-stealth-bomber-with-embedded-engine-configuration\\_fig1\\_268574716](https://www.researchgate.net/figure/B-2-Spirit-stealth-bomber-with-embedded-engine-configuration_fig1_268574716)

# RADAR technology



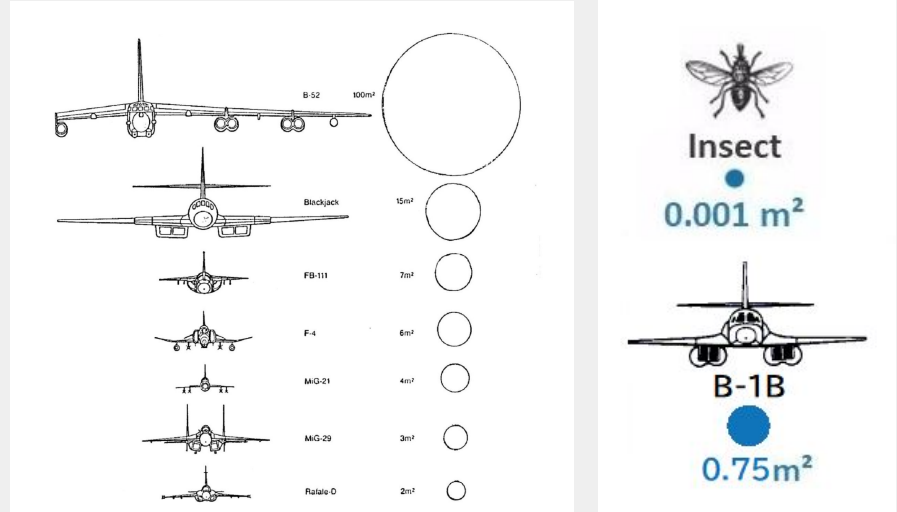
<https://www.thinkautonomous.ai/blog/how-radars-work/>

# Radio Cross Section (RCS)



Ground-based radar and aircraft monostatic scattering.

[https://wipl-d.com/wp-content/uploads/2021/06/RCS\\_016\\_WIPL-D\\_Monostatic\\_Bistatic\\_Multistatic\\_Radar\\_Scenarios\\_2021.pdf](https://wipl-d.com/wp-content/uploads/2021/06/RCS_016_WIPL-D_Monostatic_Bistatic_Multistatic_Radar_Scenarios_2021.pdf)

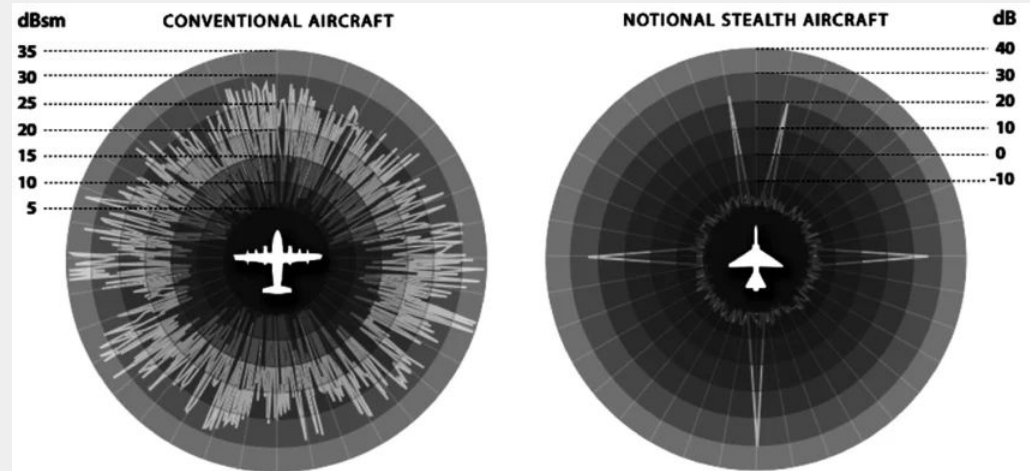
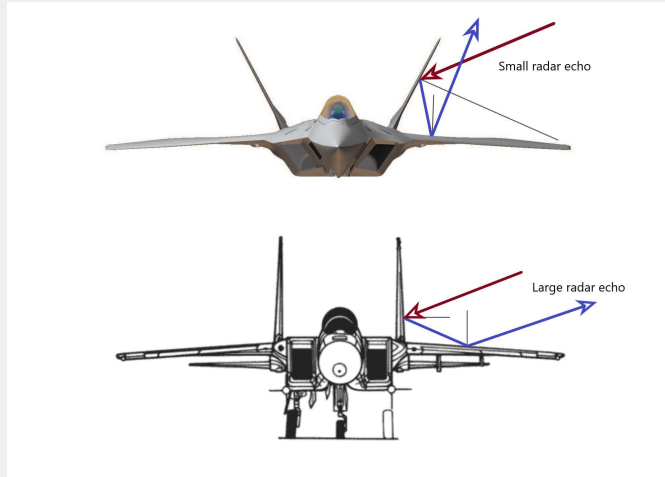


Comparison of RCS of various objects in flight

<https://www.slideshare.net/slideshow/report-on-stealth-technology/65096843>



# Radio signature and back-scattering



<https://medium.com/geekculture/heres-how-a-2-billion-dollar-flying-wing-can-disappear-from-the-radar-screen-a8e0b9d6cd1a>

[https://www.researchgate.net/figure/Illustration-of-a-Conventional-and-b-Stealth-Aircraft-Radar-Cross-Section-Signature\\_fig4\\_308781073](https://www.researchgate.net/figure/Illustration-of-a-Conventional-and-b-Stealth-Aircraft-Radar-Cross-Section-Signature_fig4_308781073)

## Variance in shape across stealth aircrafts



Northrop B-2 Spirit

[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Northrop\\_B-2\\_Spirit](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Northrop_B-2_Spirit)



Lockheed Martin F-35  
Lightning II

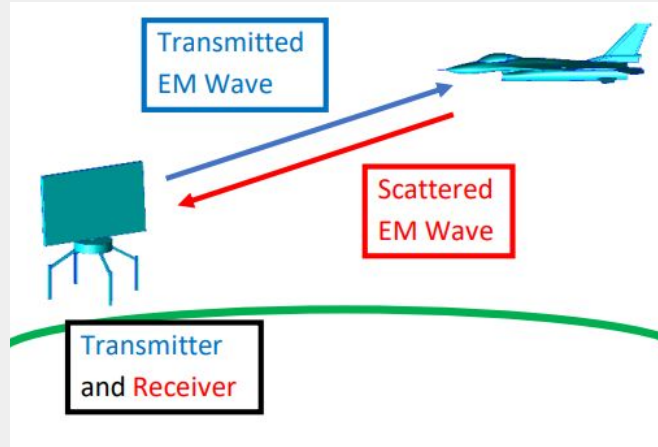
[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lockheed\\_Martin\\_F-35\\_Lightning\\_II](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lockheed_Martin_F-35_Lightning_II)



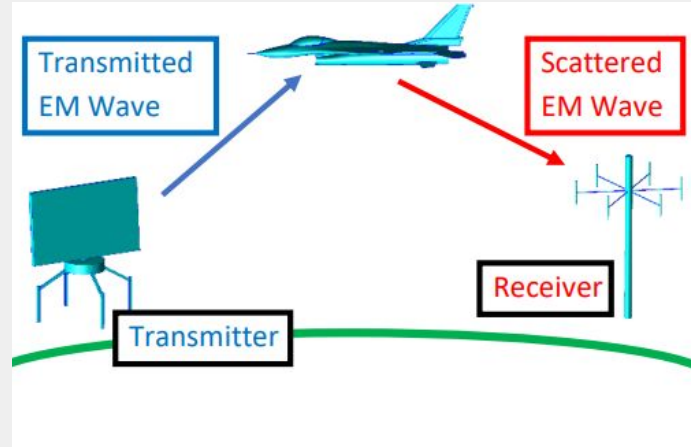
Lockheed F-117 Nighthawk

[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lockheed\\_F-117\\_Nighthawk](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lockheed_F-117_Nighthawk)

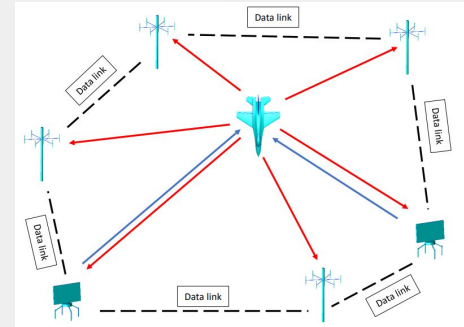
## Consideration: types of radio wave detection



Monostatic scattering



Bistatic scattering



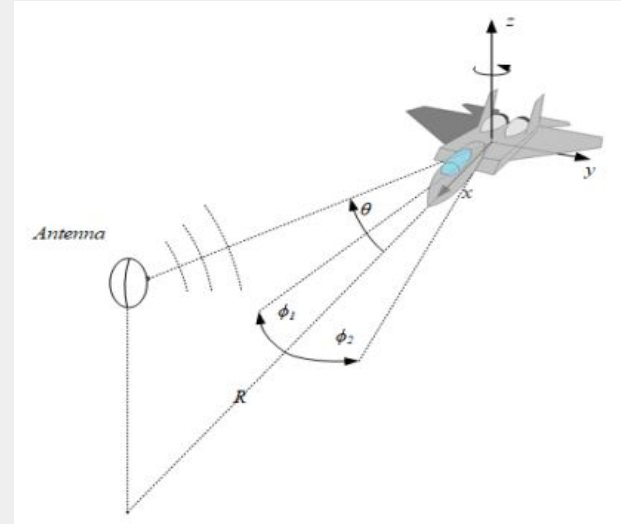
Multistatic scattering??

## Consideration: orientation



Cockpit of B-2 stealth plane

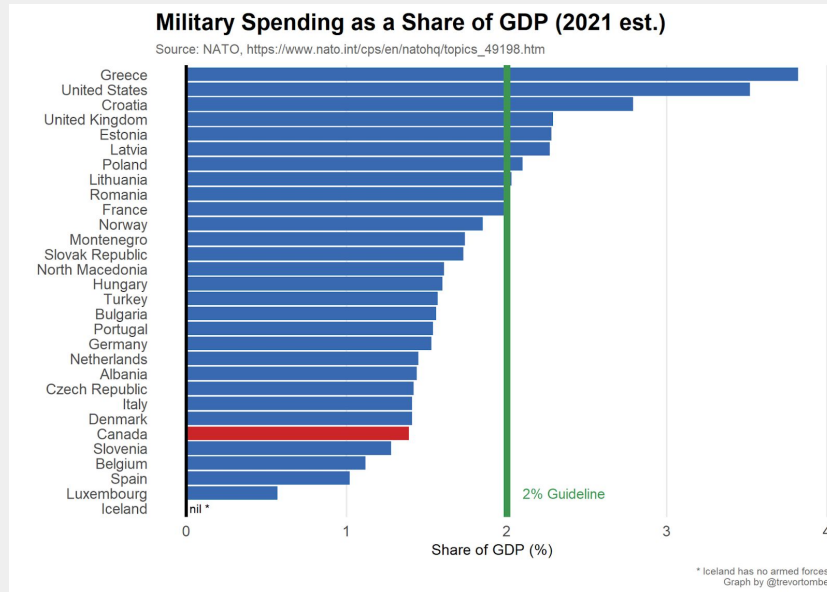
<https://theaviationist.com/2019/04/29/here-are-some-interesting-details-weve-noticed-in-the-first-ever-video-filmed-inside-a-b-2s-cockpit-while-in-flight/>



Point of earliest detection

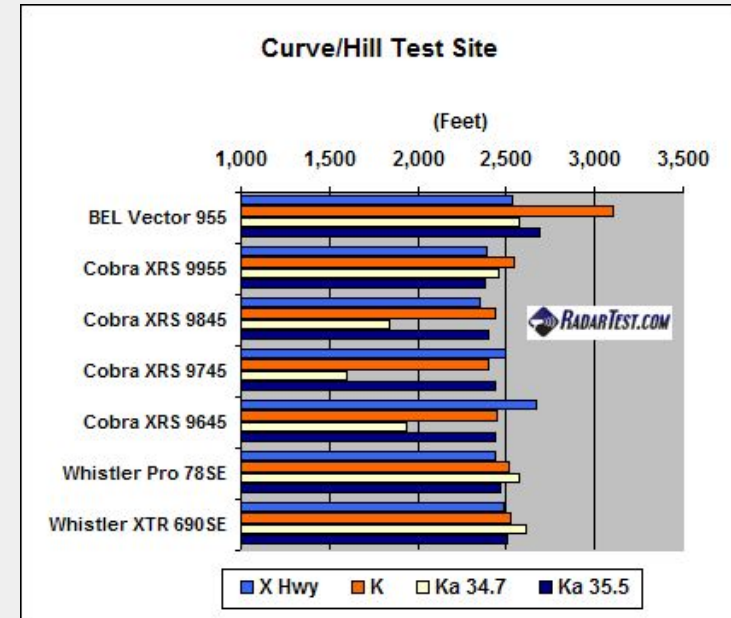
[https://wipl-d.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/09/RCS\\_007\\_WIPL-D\\_Detecting\\_Aircraft\\_Shape\\_via\\_SAR.pdf](https://wipl-d.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/09/RCS_007_WIPL-D_Detecting_Aircraft_Shape_via_SAR.pdf)

**Proposal:** (physics model capable of) optimizing geometry of an aircraft body to minimize its RADAR visibility



Canada has increased military spending

<https://thehub.ca/2022/03/30/what-increased-military-spending-may-mean-for-canadas-budget/>



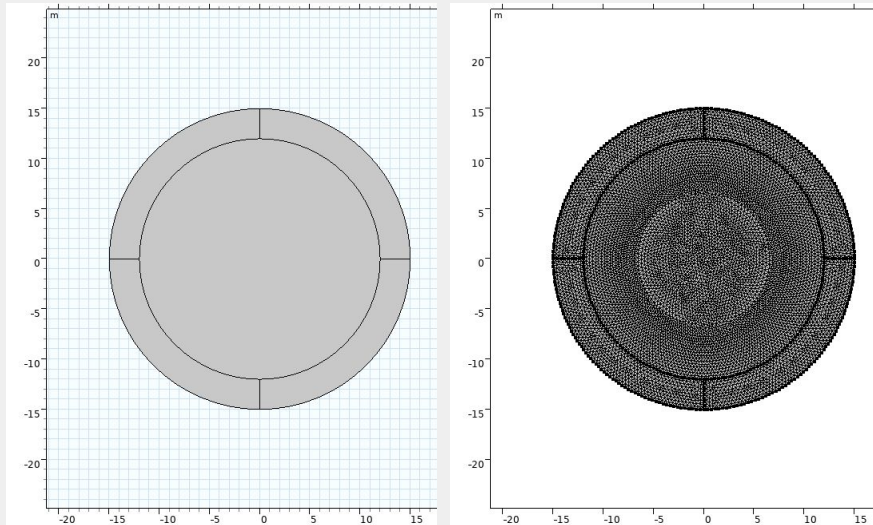
RADAR detectors fulfil Moore's Law

<https://radartest.com/article.asp?articleid=100623>

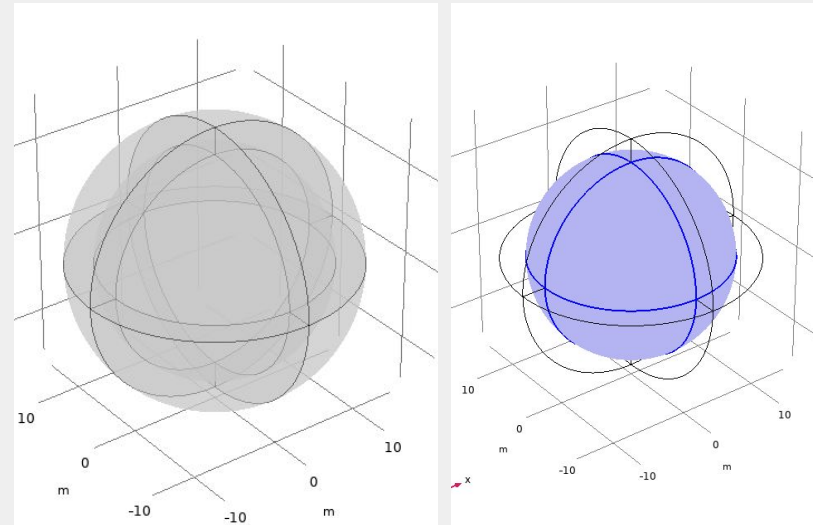


# COMSOL RADAR field model

## 2D



## 3D



## Physics: *Electromagnetic waves, frequency domain*

$$\mathbf{E}_{b,2D} = \exp(jk_0(x\cos(\phi) + y\sin(\phi))) \mathbf{e}_z$$

$$\mathbf{E}_{b,3D} = \exp(jk_0x) \mathbf{e}_z$$

$j$  is the imaginary unit

$k_0 = 2\pi f/c$  is the wave number in vacuum

$c = 3 * 10^8$  m/s is the speed of light

$f = 100$  MHz is the frequency

$\phi$  is the angle of incidence

$\phi = 0$  corresponds to a wave incident from the positive  $x$  direction (and hence propagating in the negative  $x$  direction, from right to left in the model)

2D and 3D wave equation

Scatter field formulation

Background electric field

<https://doc.comsol.com/6.3/doc/com.comsol.help.rf/RFModuleUsersGuide.pdf>

$\mathbf{E}_{rel} = \mathbf{E} - \mathbf{E}_b$  where  $\mathbf{E}$  is the total, measurable field.

$$\nabla \times (\mu_r^{-1} \nabla \times \mathbf{E}_{rel}) - \left( \epsilon_r - j \frac{\sigma}{\omega \epsilon_0} \right) k_0^2 \mathbf{E}_{rel} = 0$$

## Physics: *Electromagnetic waves, frequency domain*

The relative field is the difference between the measured field caused by the presence of the plane and the background field. It is utilized to describe how detectable the boat is with the radar – its RCS. The RCS of 3D scatterer is defined as

$$\sigma_{3D} = \lim_{r \rightarrow \infty} 4\pi r^2 \frac{|\mathbf{E}_{\text{rel}}|^2}{|\mathbf{E}_b|^2}$$

The RCS per unit length of a 2D scatterer addresses monostatic scattering characteristics at the angle where the incident wave comes from. It is defined as

$$\sigma_{2D} = \lim_{r \rightarrow \infty} 2\pi r \frac{|\mathbf{E}_{\text{rel}}|^2}{|\mathbf{E}_b|^2}$$

2D and 3D RCS

<https://doc.comsol.com/6.3/doc/com.comsol.help.rf/RFModuleUsersGuide.pdf>

## Physics: *Electromagnetic waves, frequency domain*

The far field can be calculated from the near field using the Stratton-Chu formula:

$$\mathbf{E}_{p,3D} = \frac{jk}{4\pi} \mathbf{r}_0 \times \int_S [\mathbf{n} \times \mathbf{E} - \eta \mathbf{r}_0 \times (\mathbf{n} \times \mathbf{H})] \exp(j\mathbf{k} \mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{r}_0) dS$$

$$\mathbf{E}_{p,2D} = \sqrt{j\lambda} \frac{k}{4\pi} \mathbf{r}_0 \times \int_S [\mathbf{n} \times \mathbf{E} - \eta \mathbf{r}_0 \times (\mathbf{n} \times \mathbf{H})] \exp(j\mathbf{k} \mathbf{r} \cdot \mathbf{r}_0) dS$$

$\mathbf{E}$  and  $\mathbf{H}$  are the fields on the “aperture”

$\mathbf{r}_0$  is the unit vector pointing from the origin to the field point  $p$

$\mathbf{n}$  is the unit normal to the surface  $S$

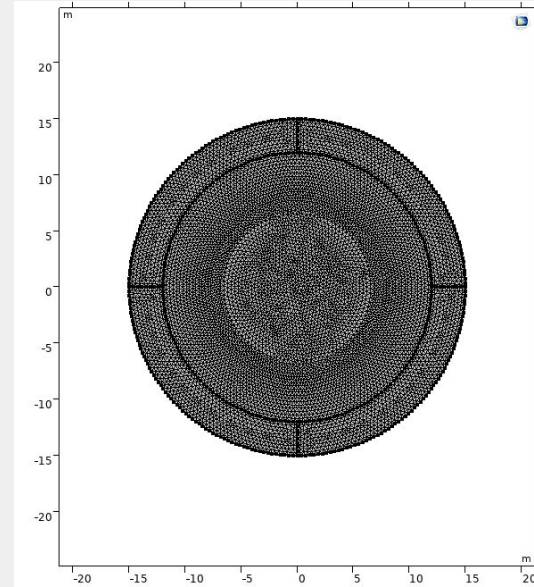
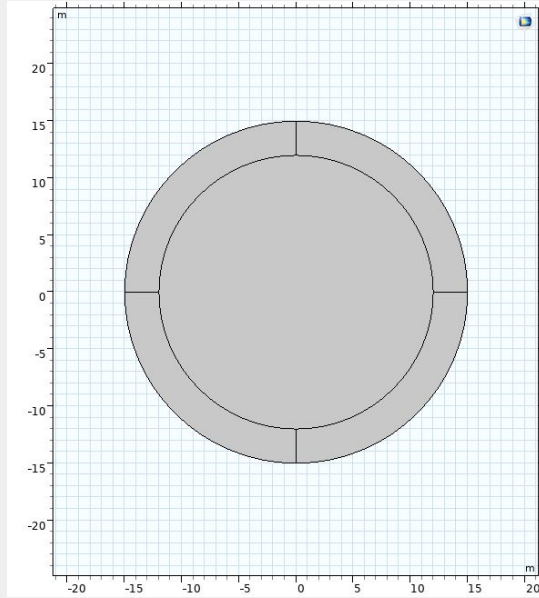
$\eta$  is the impedance:

$$\eta = \sqrt{\frac{\mu}{\epsilon}}$$

Far field calculation

<https://doc.comsol.com/6.3/doc/com.comsol.help.rf/RFModuleUsersGuide.pdf>

## 2D RADAR field geometry in COMSOL

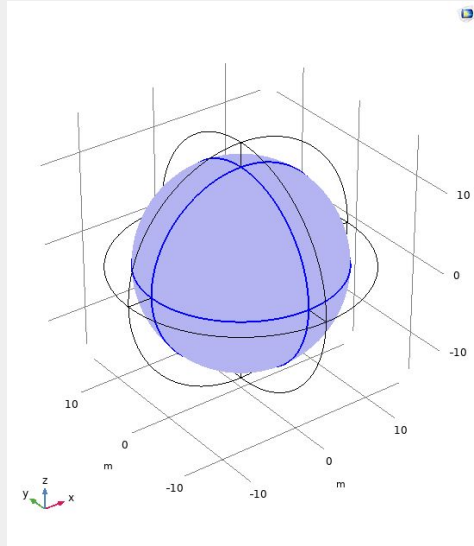


Inner circle: air surrounding the plane.

Outer circle: perfectly matched layer (PML), which minimizes unphysical reflections of the scattered wave as it leaves the model domain.

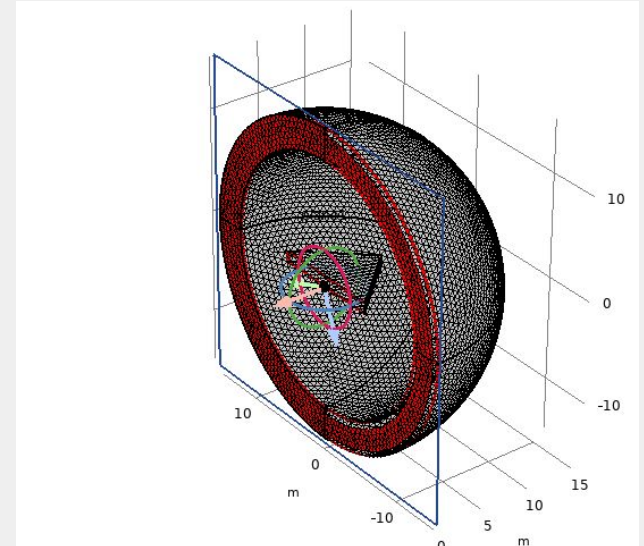
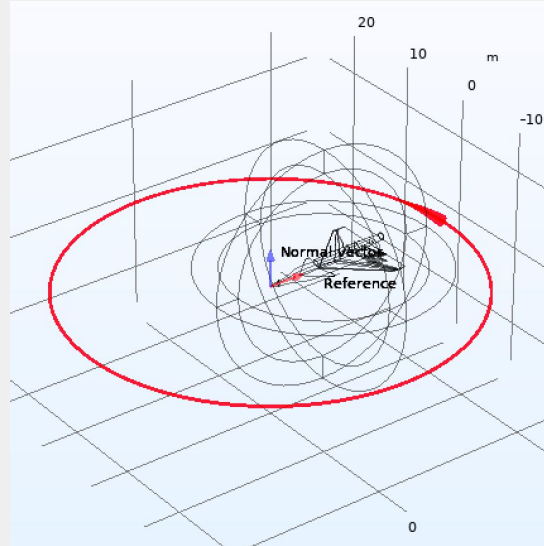


# RADAR field physics initialization



## Far-field domain

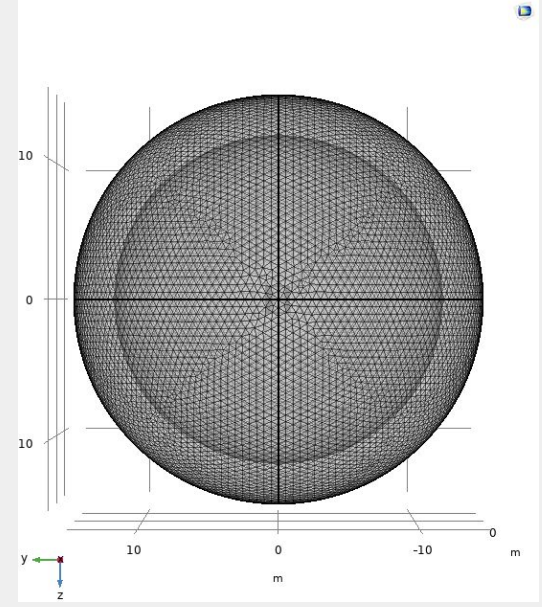
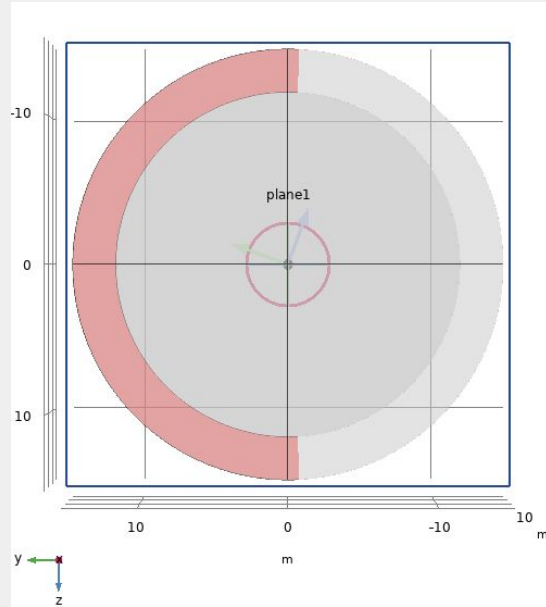
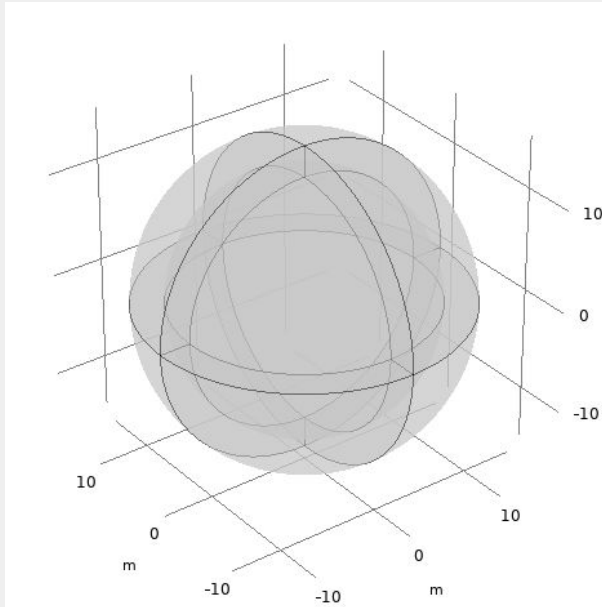
At sufficient distances, a point source of radio waves can be characterized as a plane wave



## Impedance boundary condition

At 100MHz, the skin depth of aluminum is on the order of  $1e-6$ , much less than its thickness

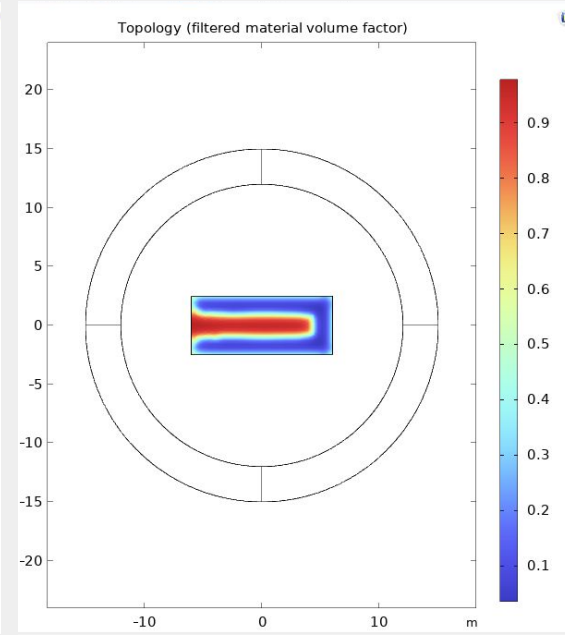
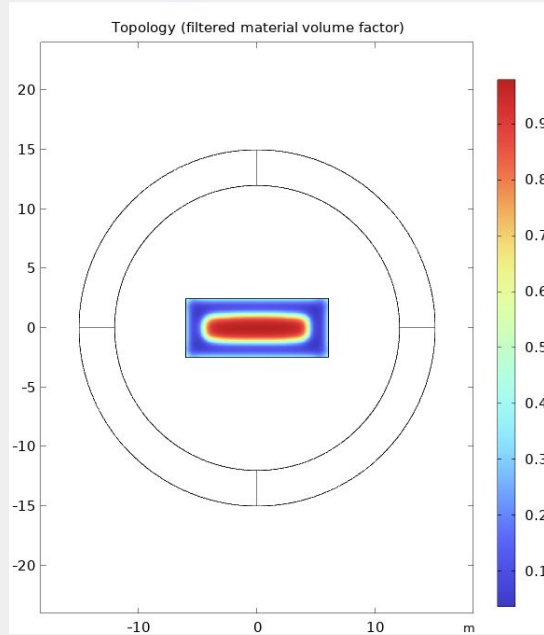
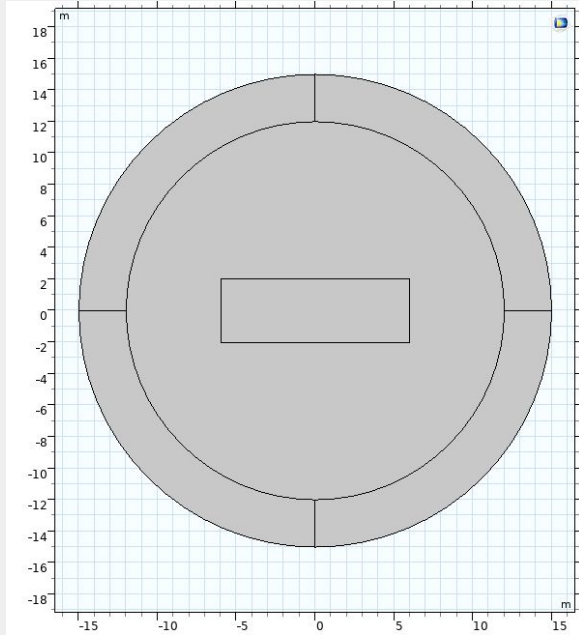
## 3D RADAR field geometry in COMSOL



Inner sphere: air surrounding the plane.

Outer shell: perfectly matched layer (PML), which minimizes unphysical reflections of the scattered wave as it leaves the model domain.

## Method 1: topology optimization

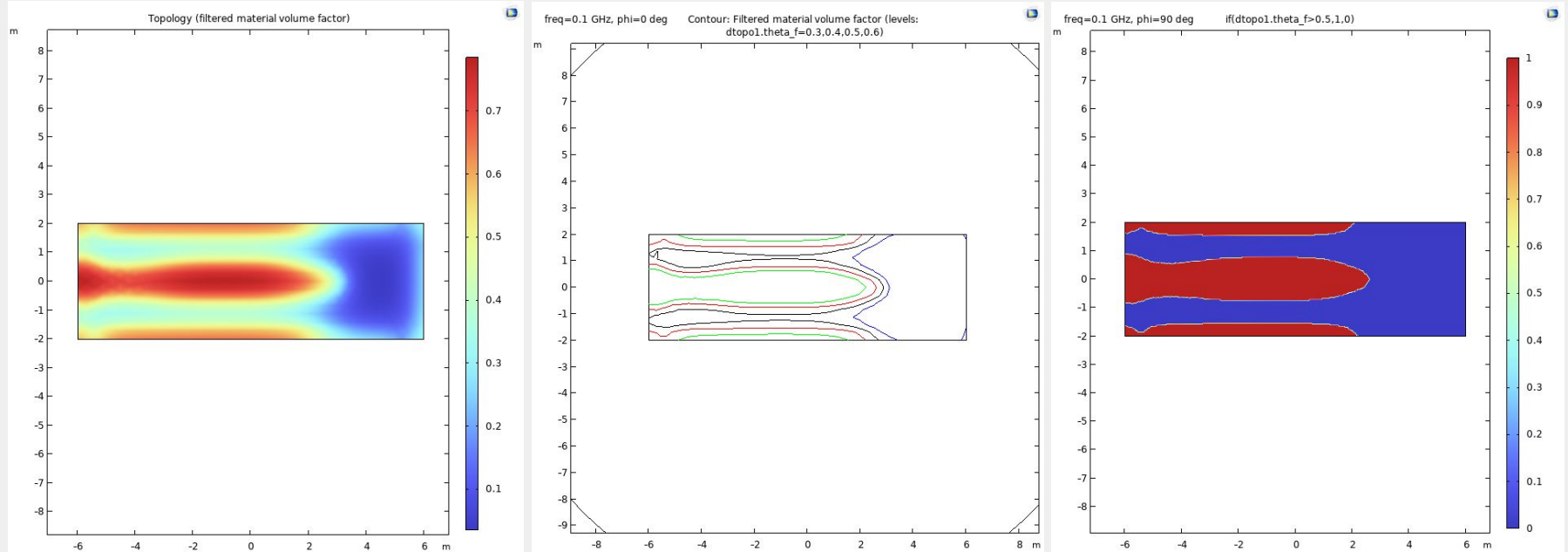


Constraints: total area

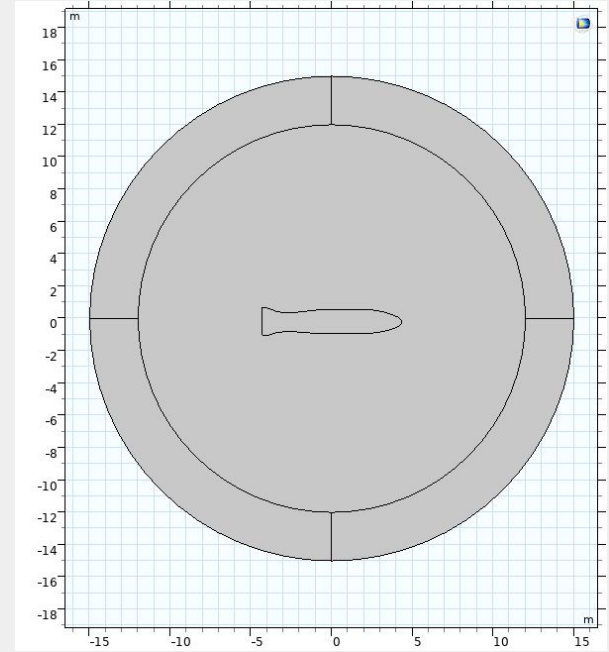
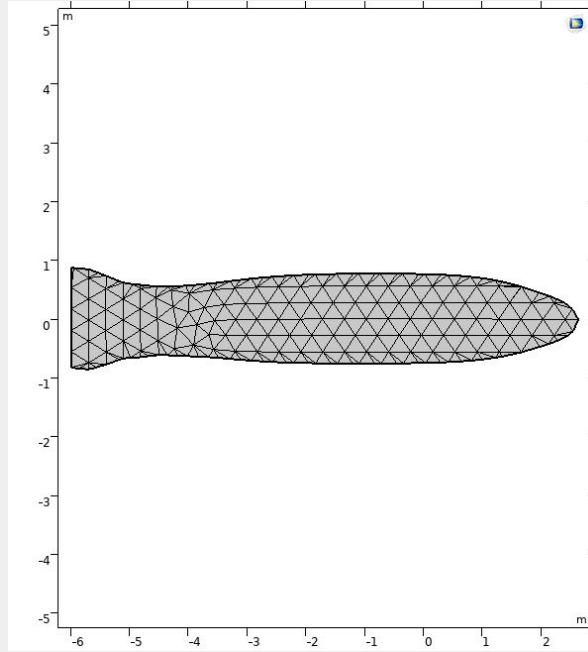
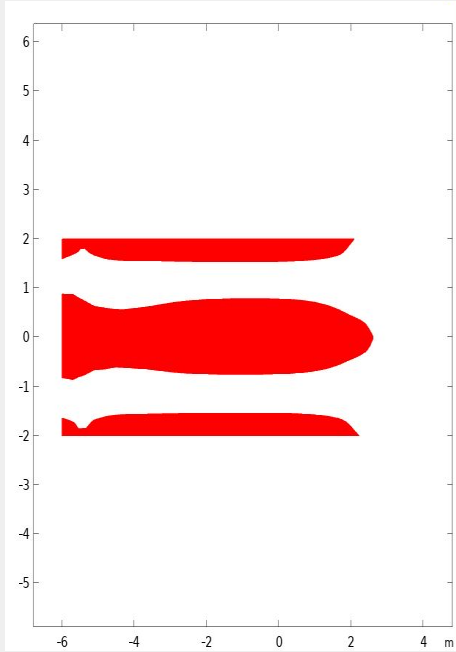
+ directional weighting

## Method 1: topology optimization

*Optimal density arrangement* → *geometric part*

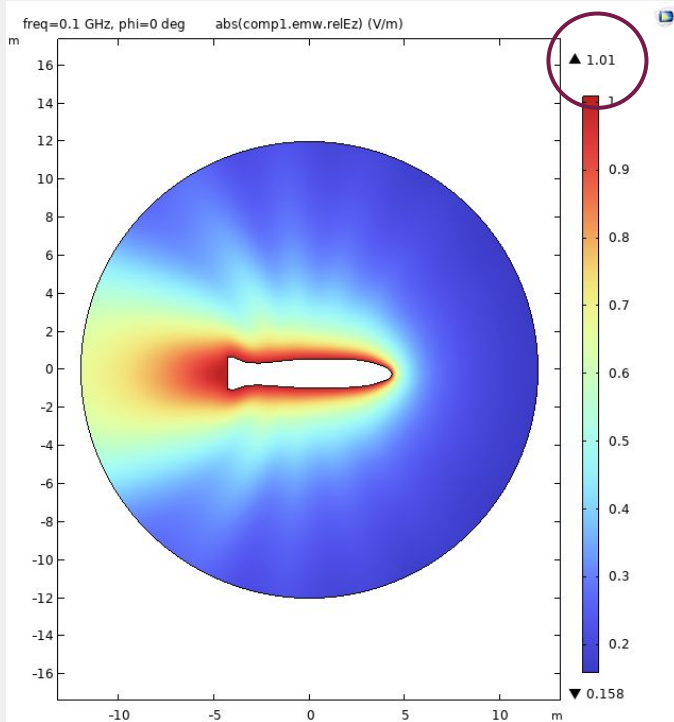


## Method 1: topology optimization

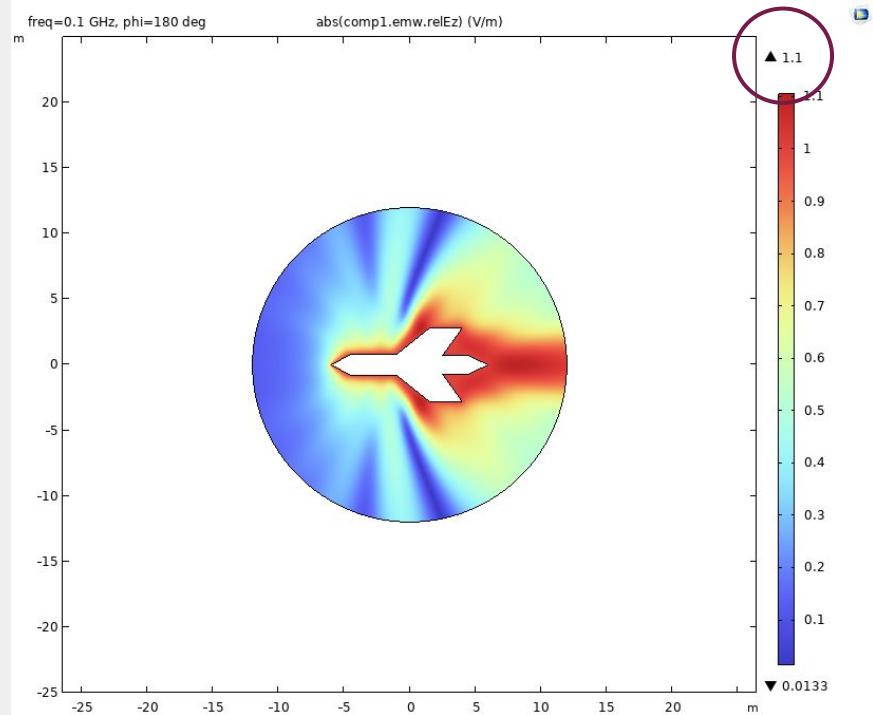


## Method 1: topology optimization

*2D results: relative electric field*



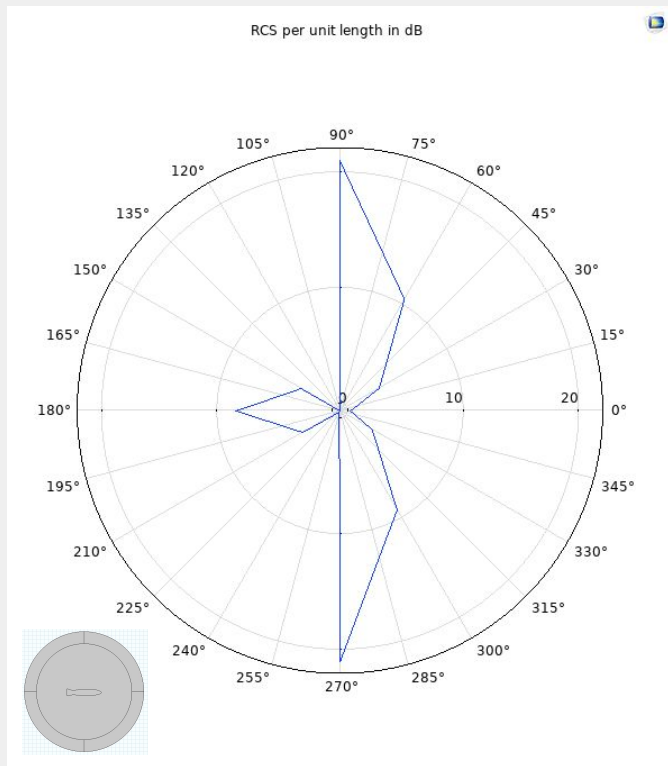
## Compare: (reflected)



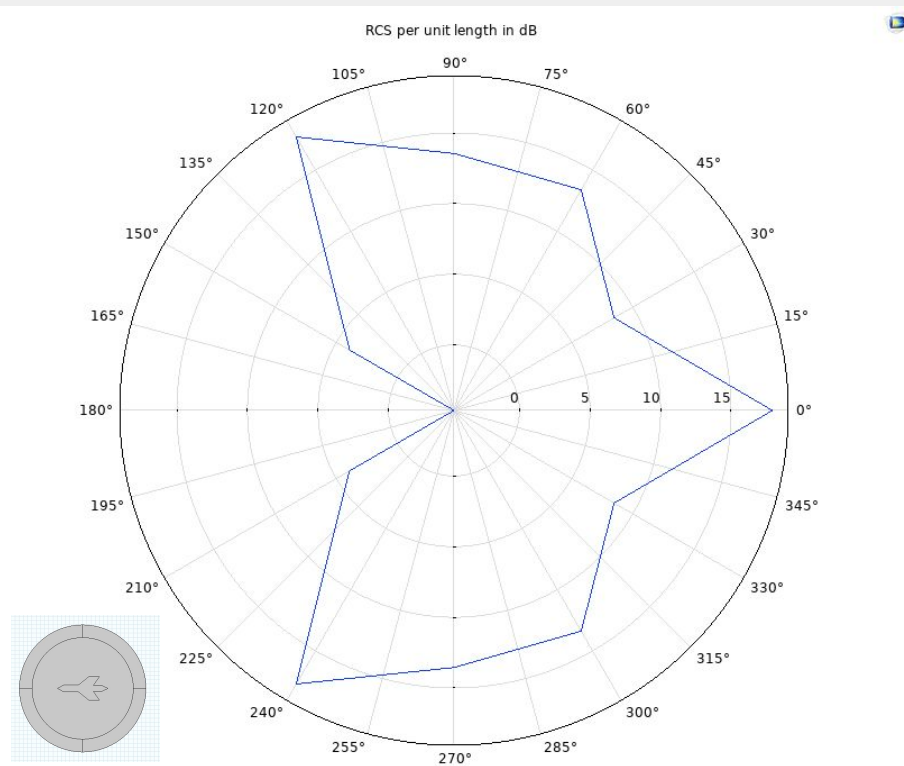


## Method 1: topology optimization

*2D results: RCS per unit length*

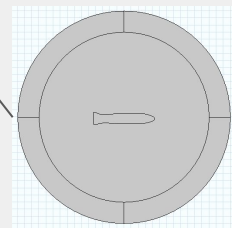
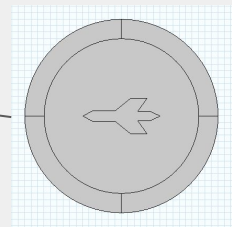
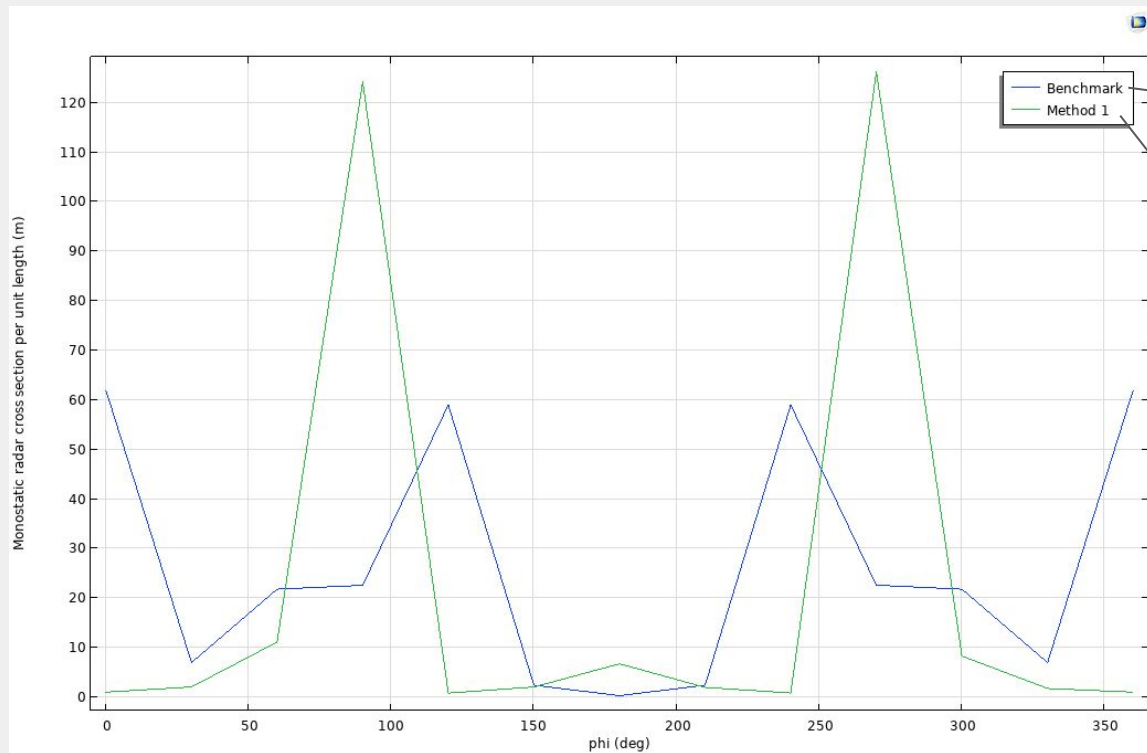


## Compare: (reflected)



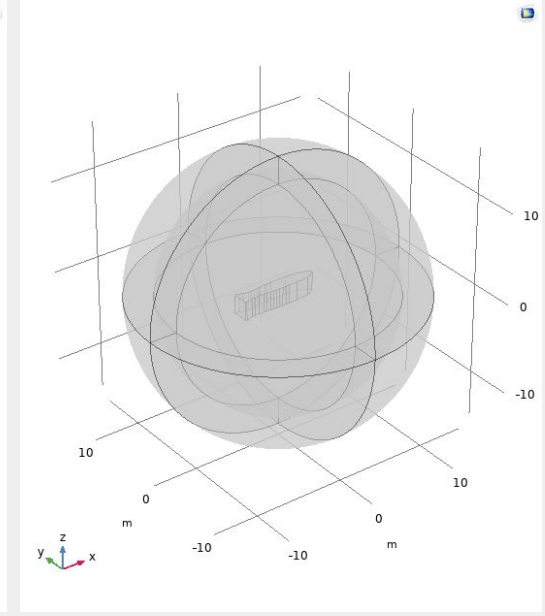
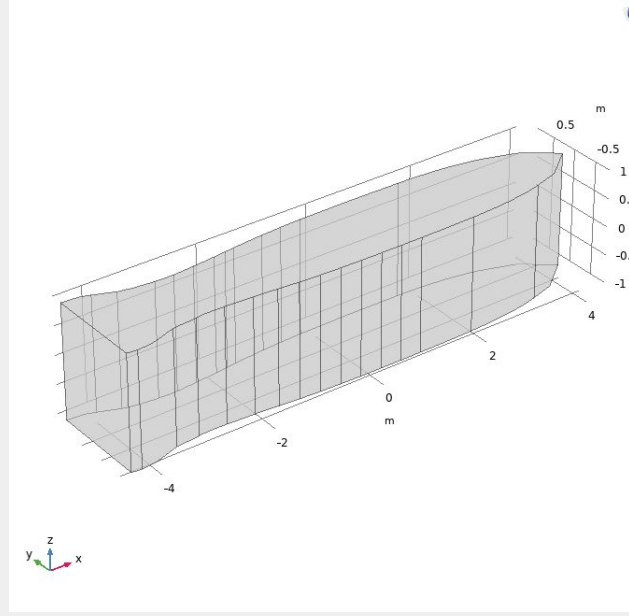
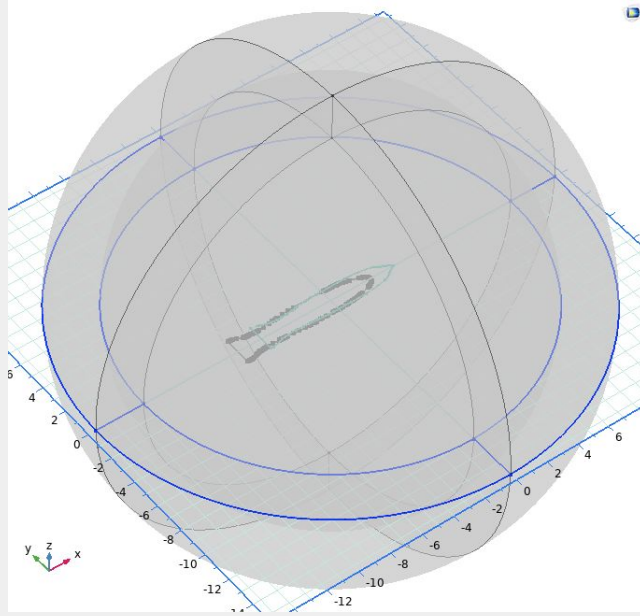
## Method 1: topology optimization

*2D results: RCS minimization*



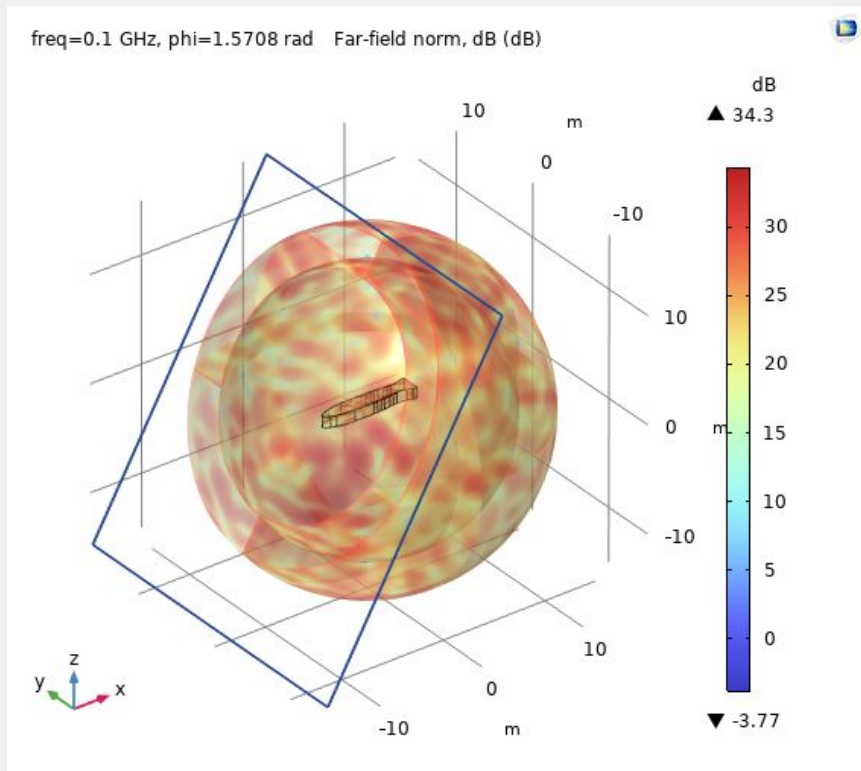
## Method 1: topology optimization

*2D part  $\rightarrow$  3D part*

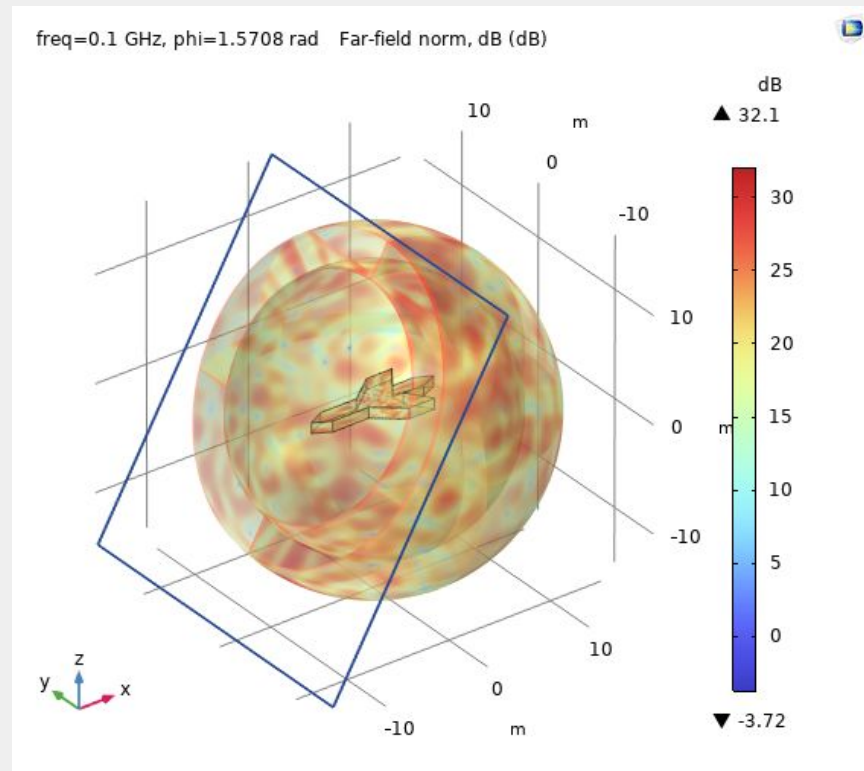


## Method 1: topology optimization

*Results: far-field norm*

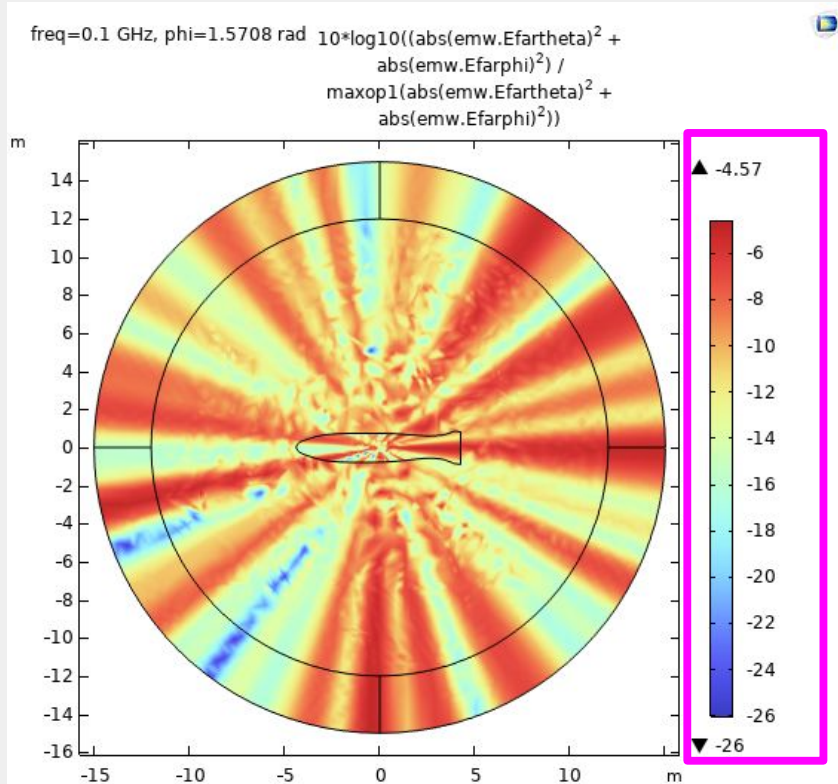


**Compare:**

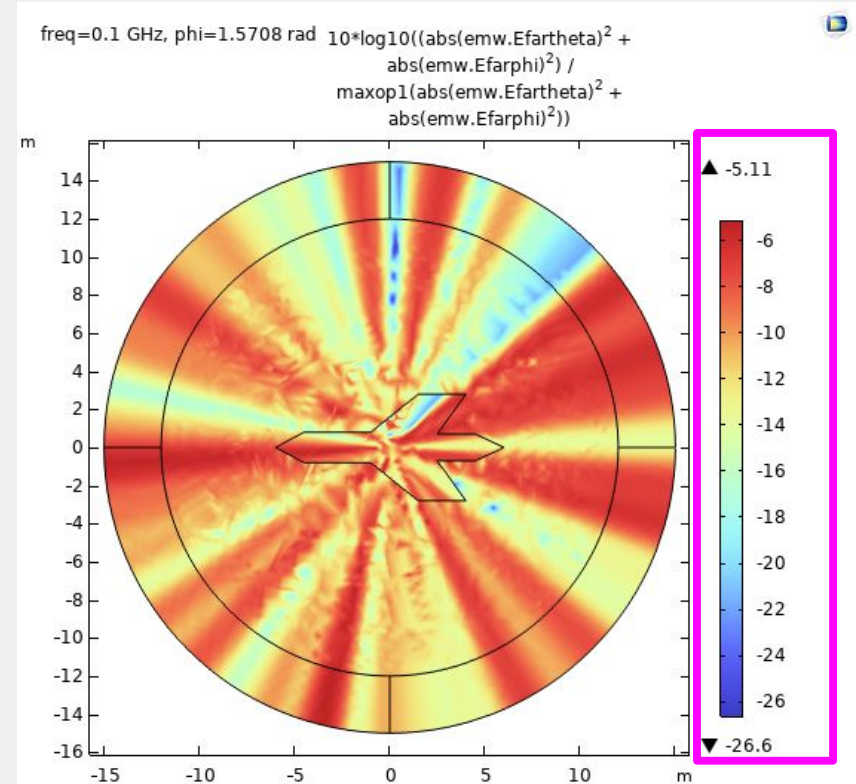


## Method 1: topology optimization

*Results: relative electric field*

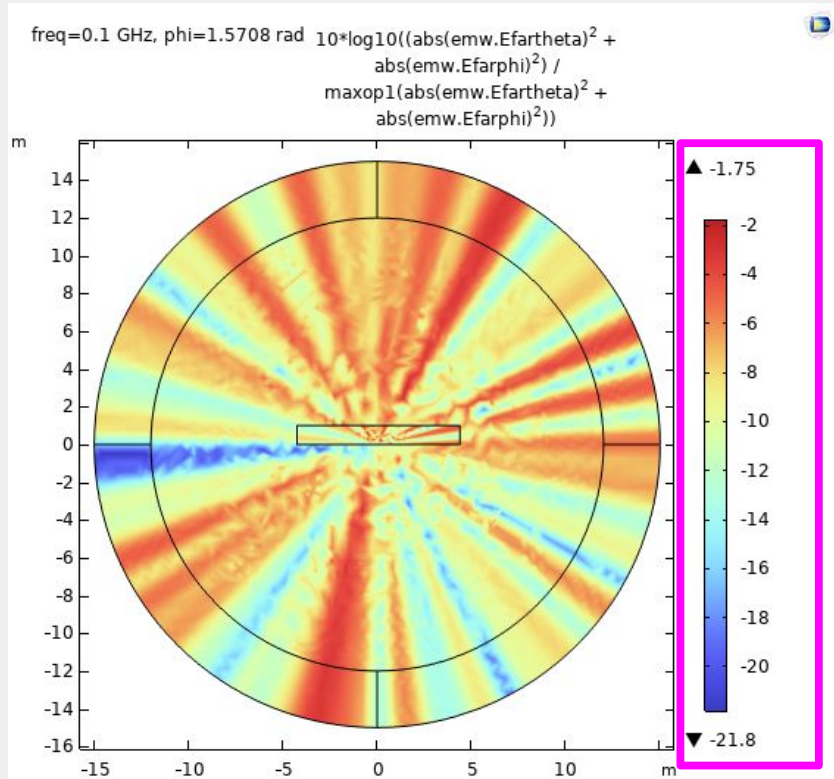


**Compare:**

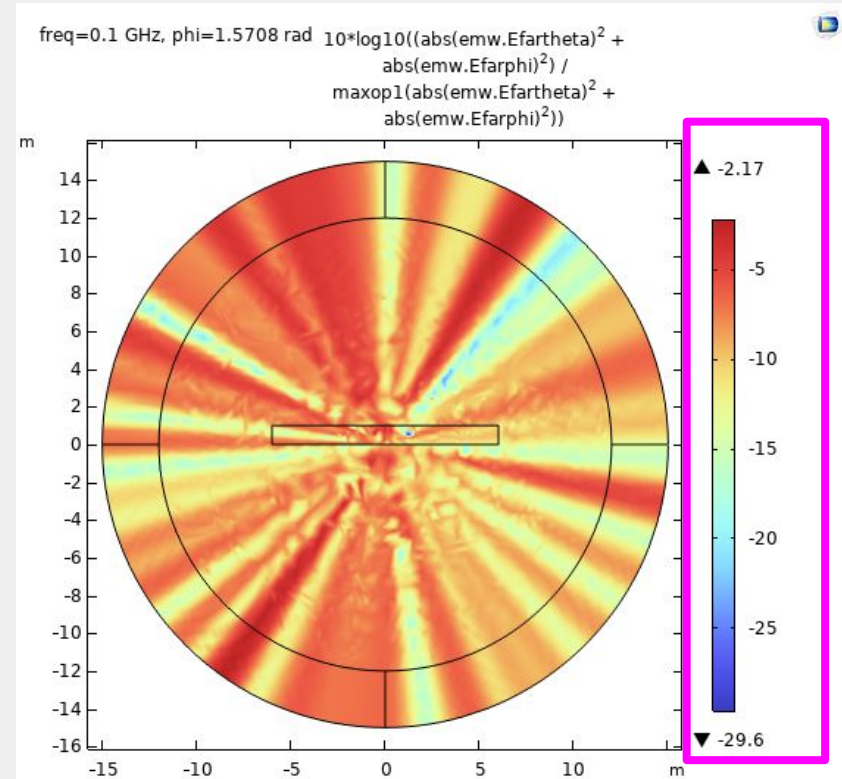


## Method 1: topology optimization

*Results: relative electric field*



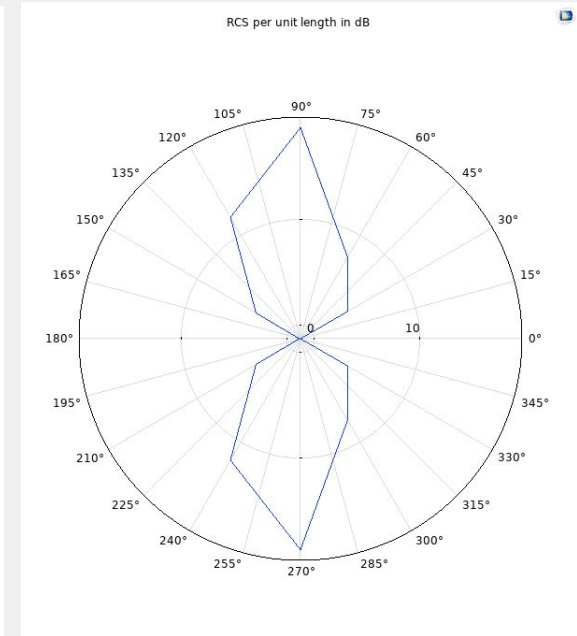
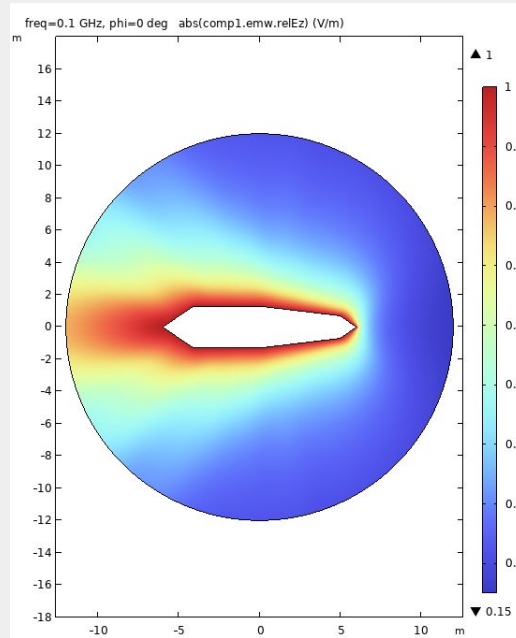
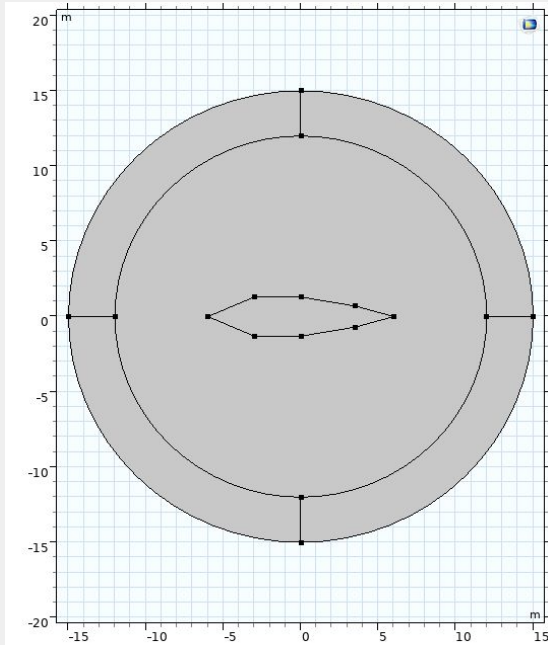
**Compare:**





## Method 2: parametric optimization

*Variance in original shape*

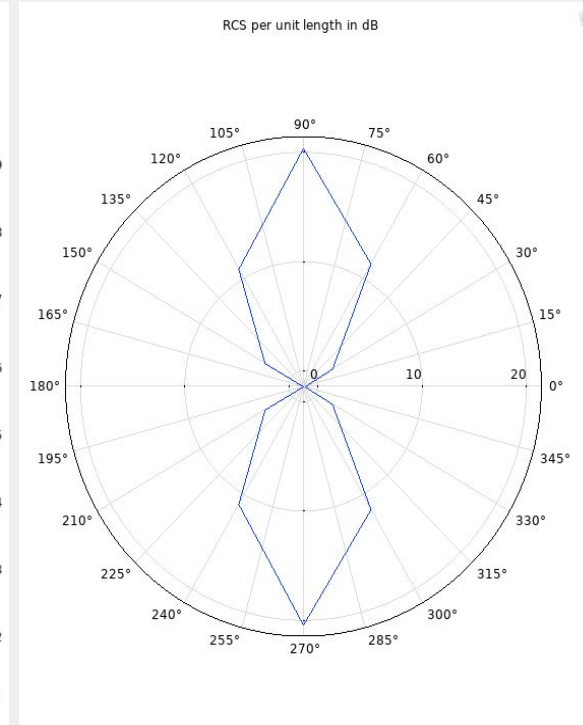
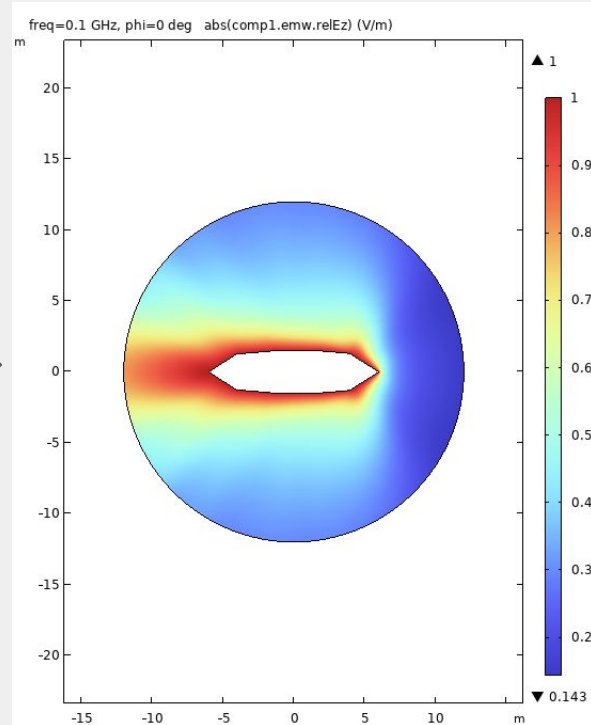
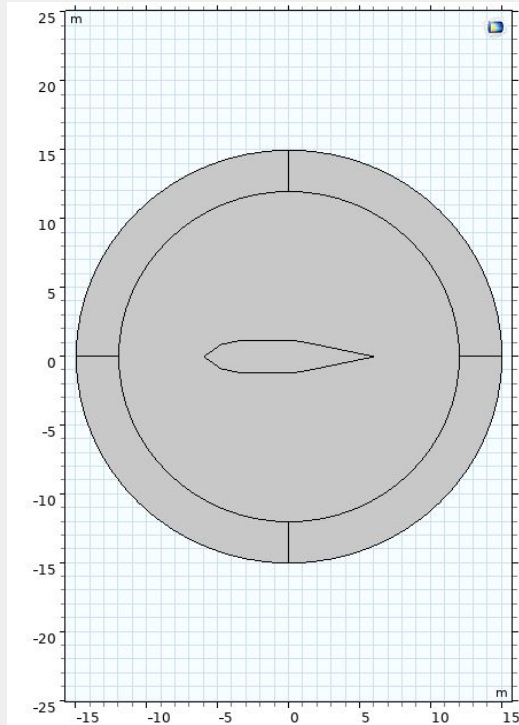


Controlled parameters: side length, interior angle.

\*\*Some restrictions on component size

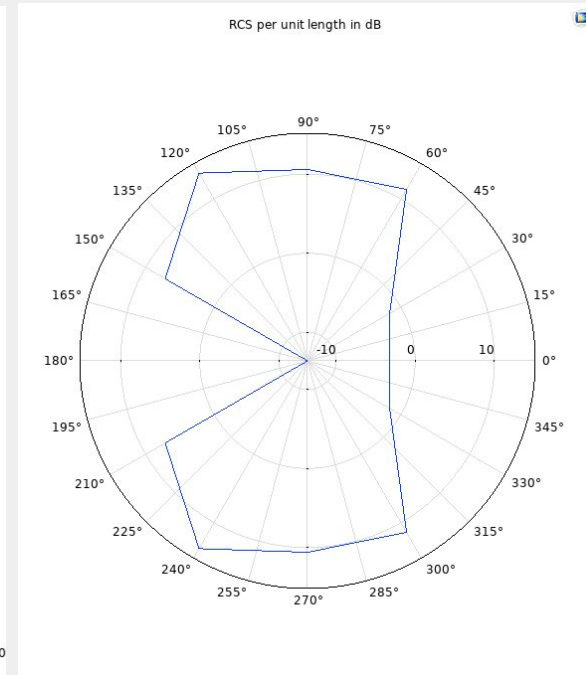
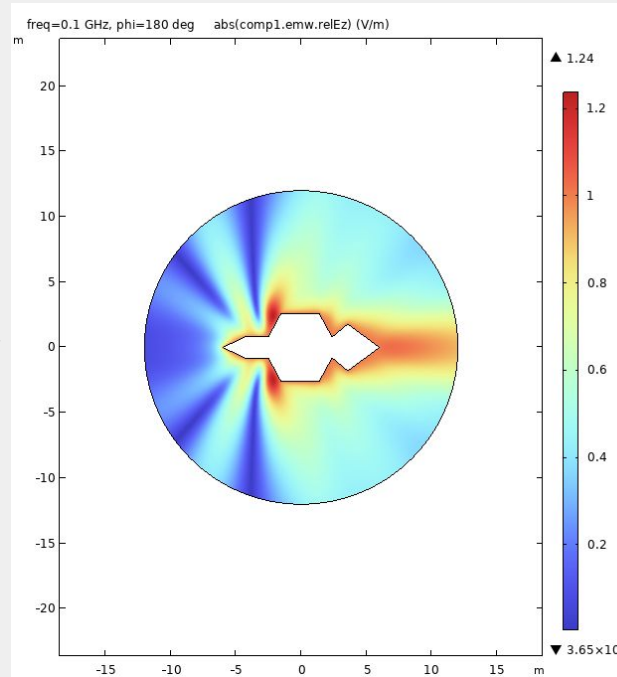
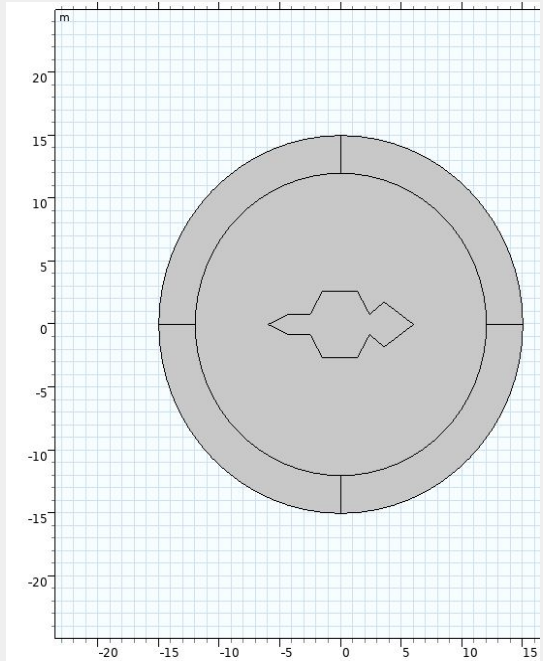
## Method 2: parametric optimization

*Variance in original shape*



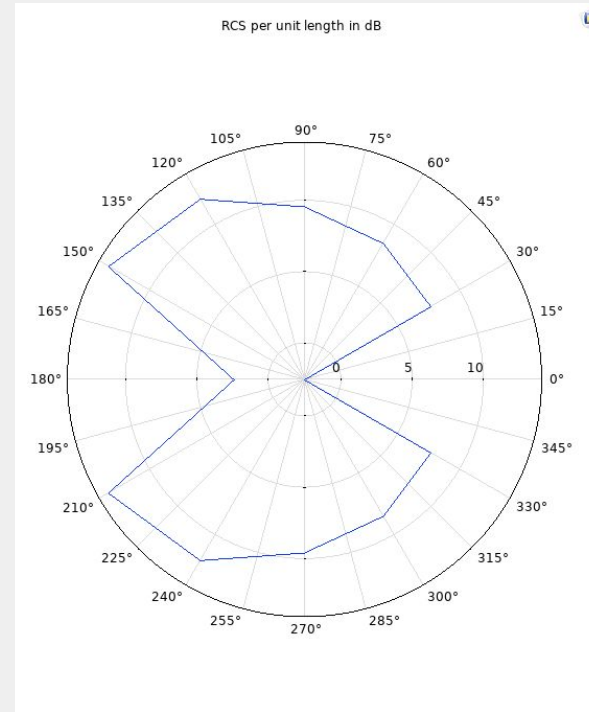
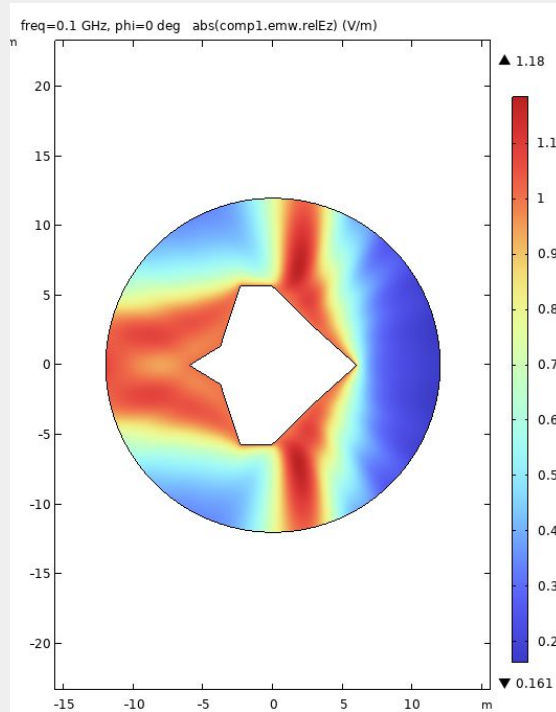
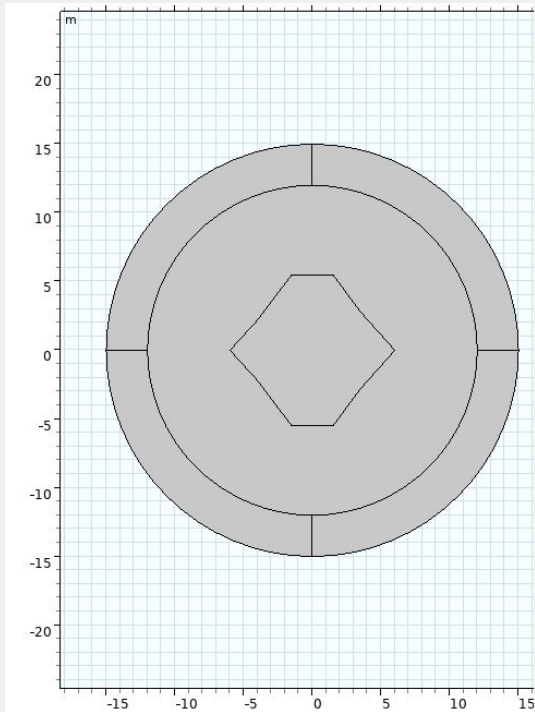
## Method 2: parametric optimization

*Variance in original shape*



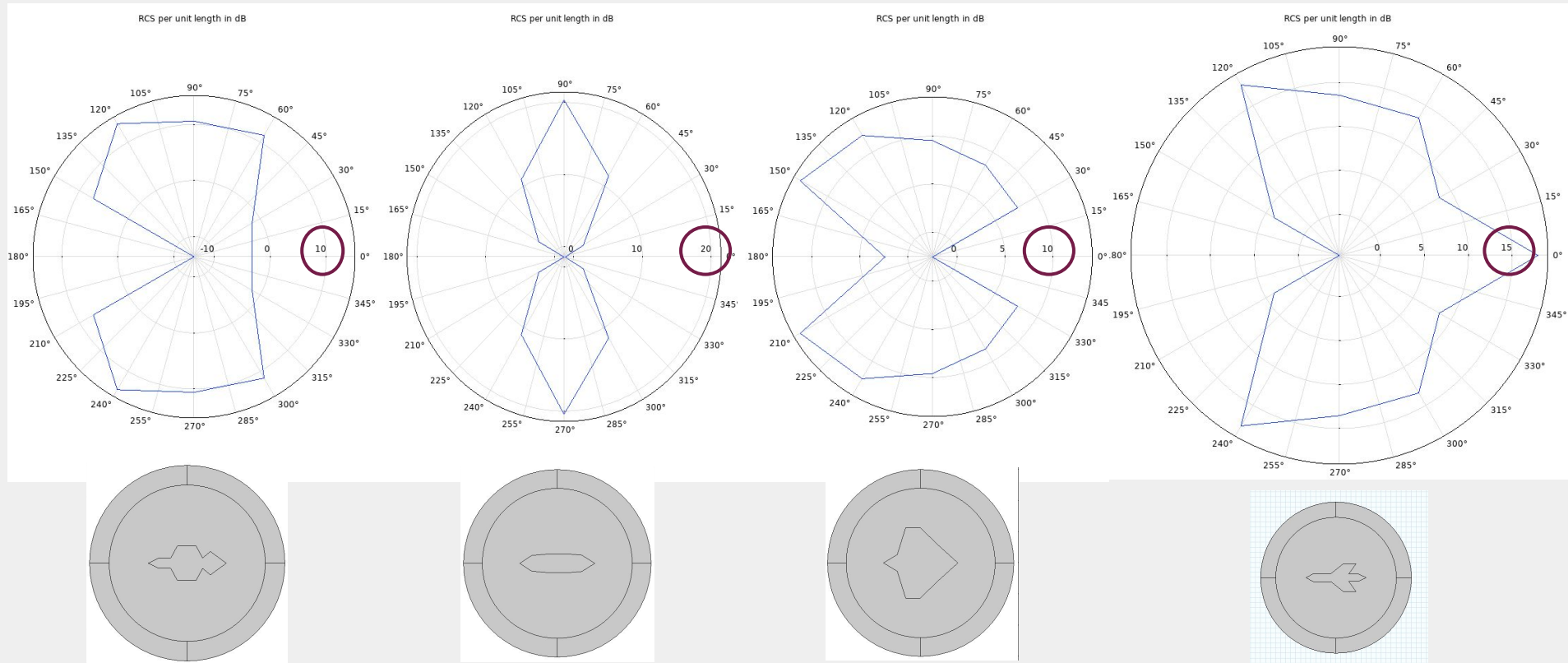
## Method 2: parametric optimization

*Variance in original shape*



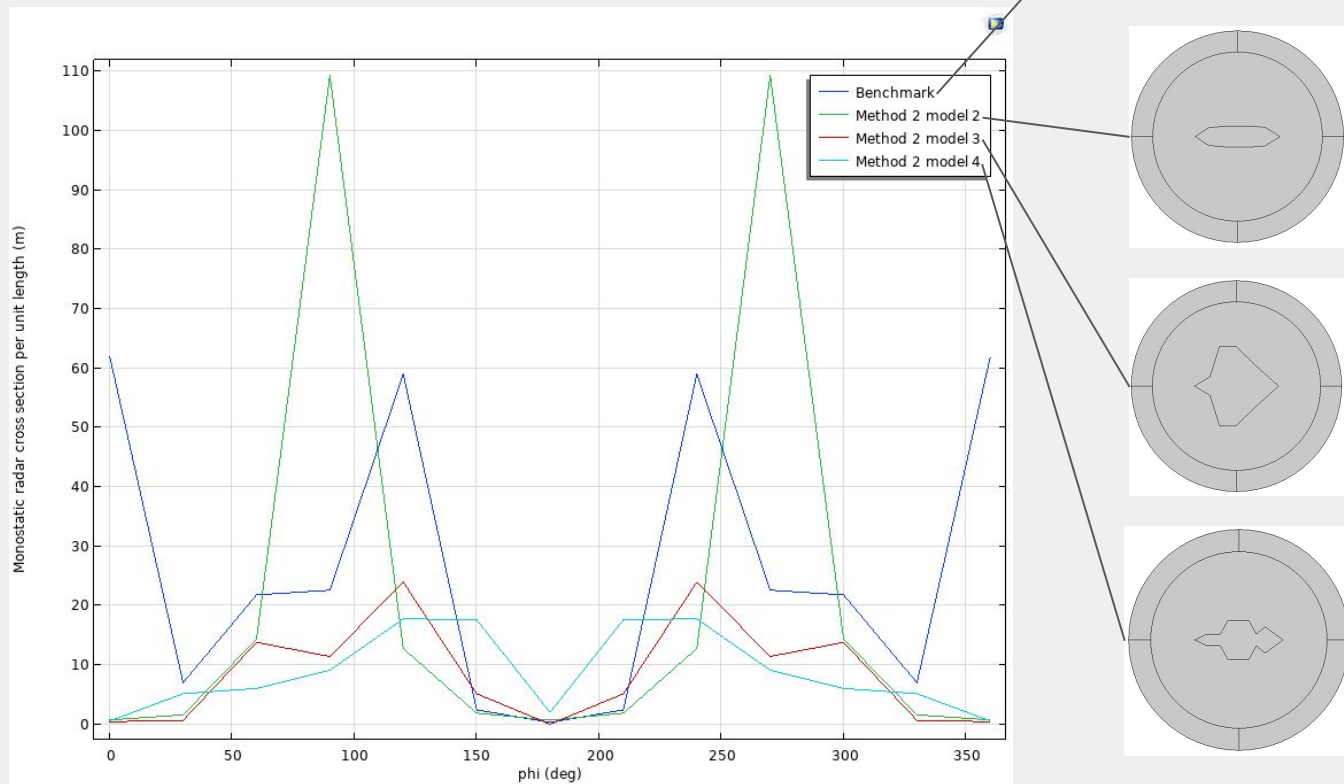
## Method 2: parametric optimization

**Compare: (reflected)**



## Method 2: parametric optimization

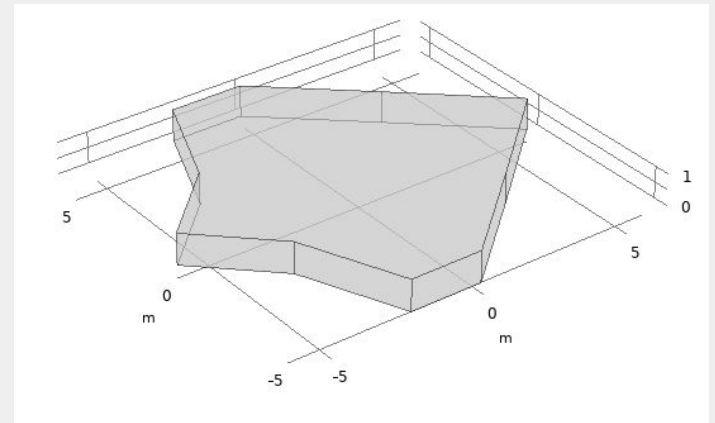
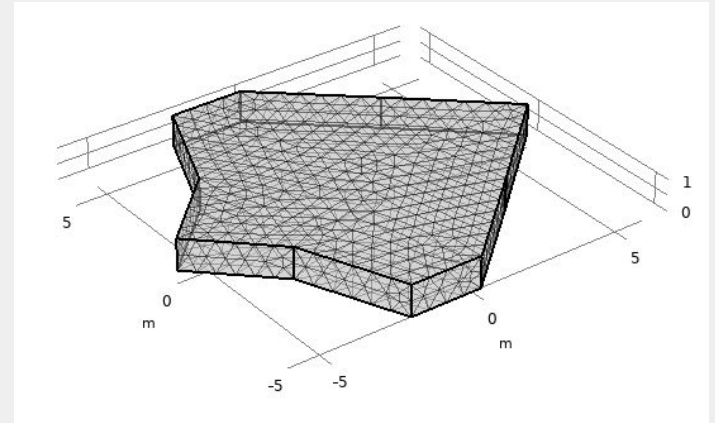
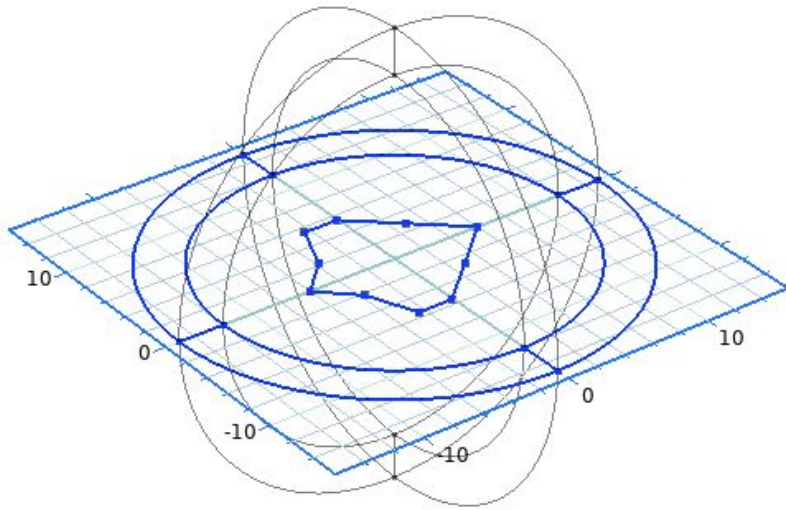
*Results: RCS minimization*





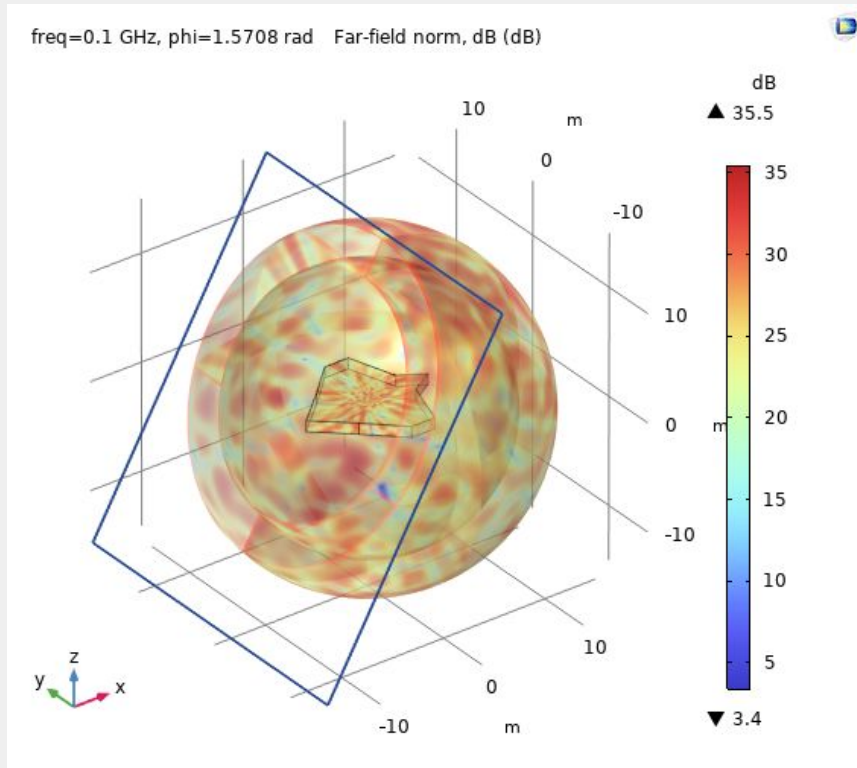
## Method 2: parametric optimization

*2D part*  $\rightarrow$  *3D part*

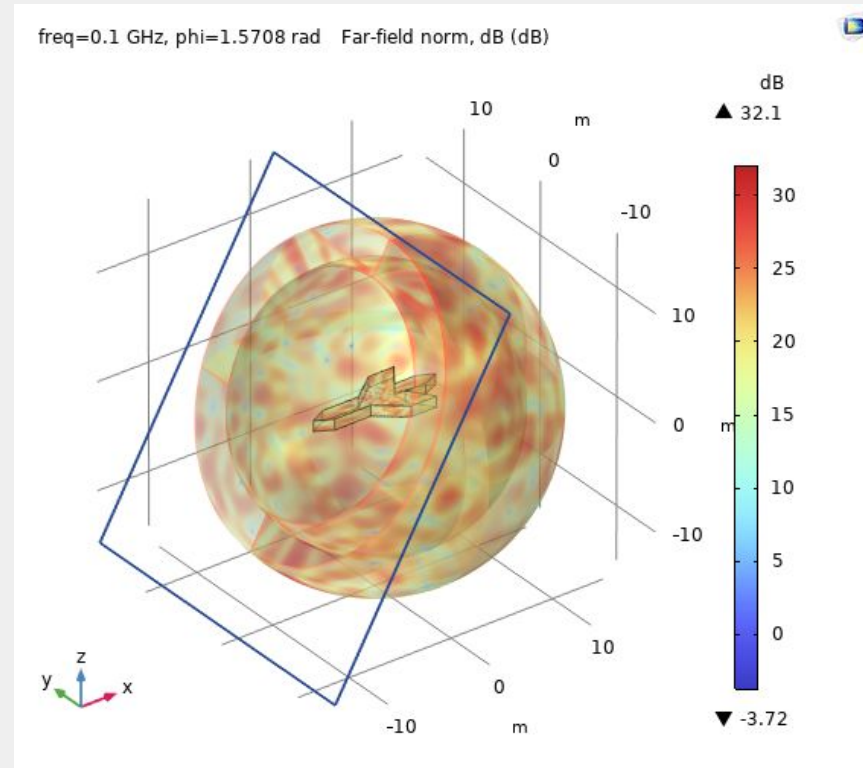


## Method 2: parametric optimization

*Results: far-field norm*

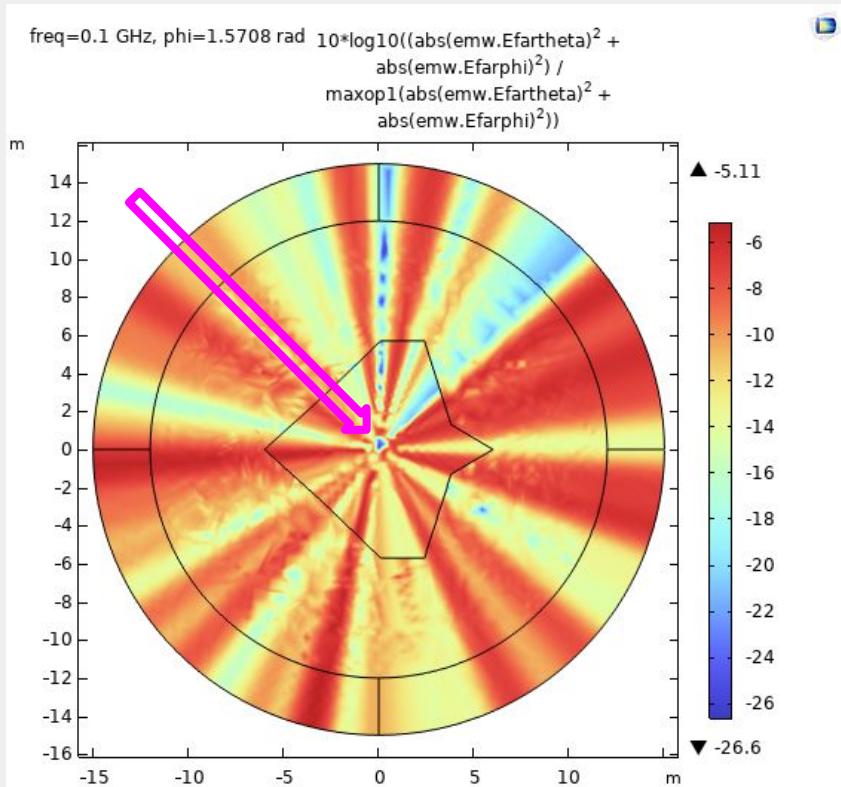


**Compare:**

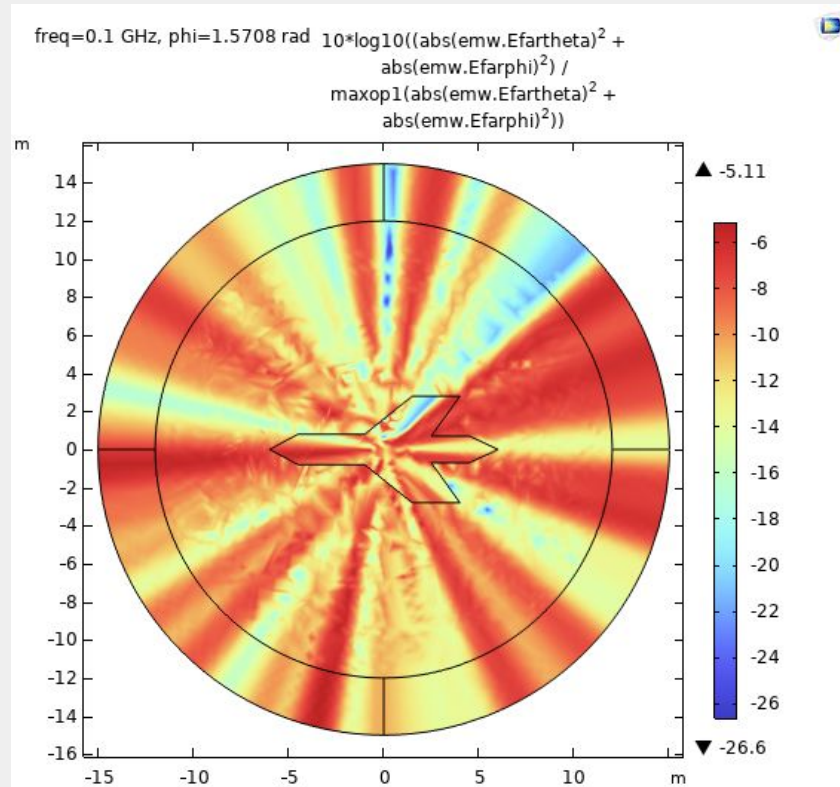


## Method 2: parametric optimization

### *Results: relative electric field*

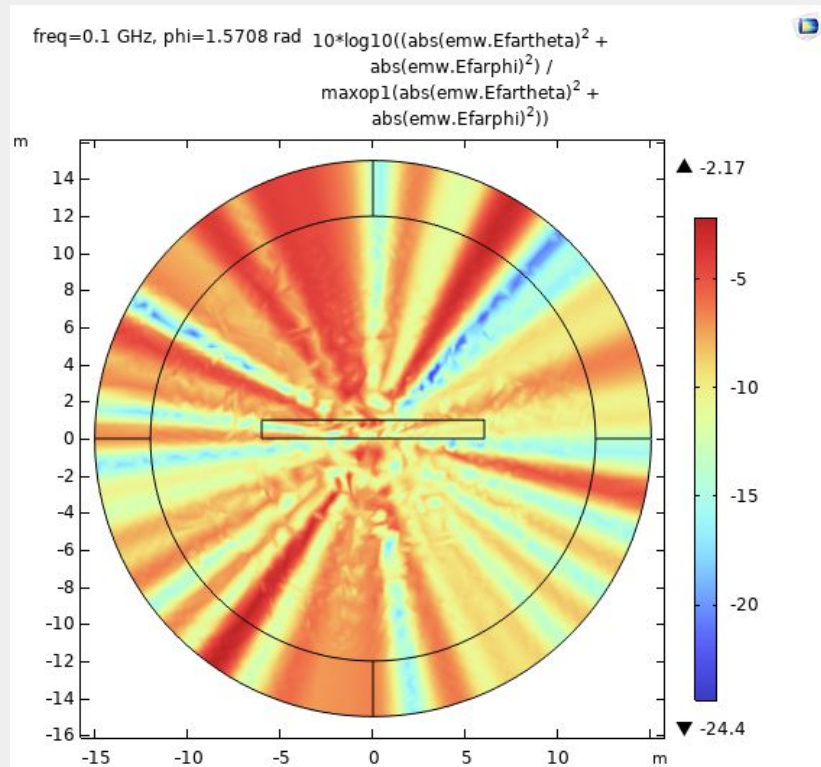


### Compare:

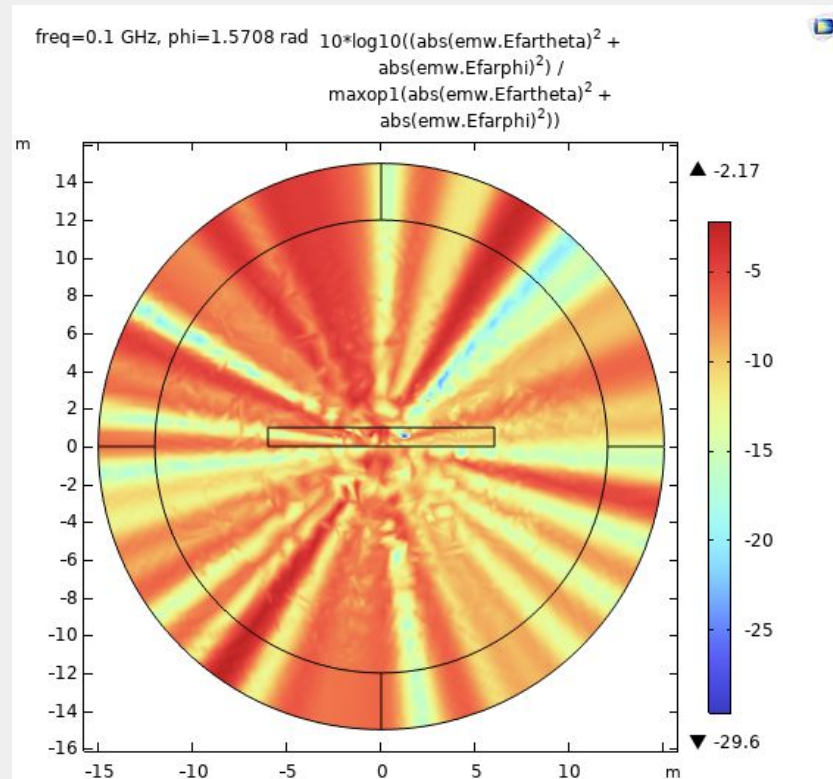


## Method 2: parametric optimization

*Results: relative electric field*

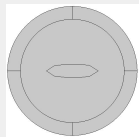
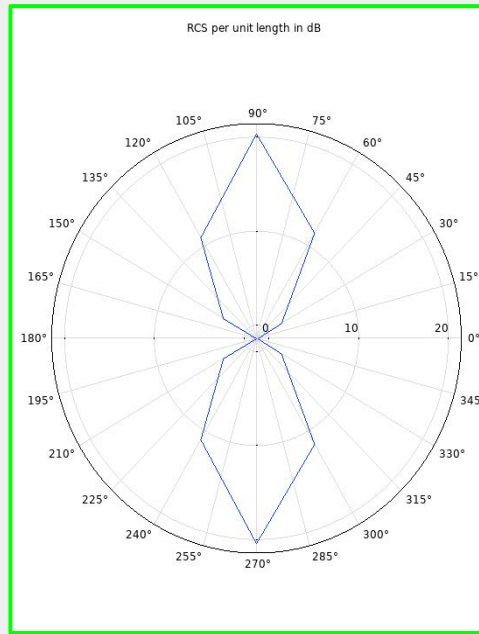


**Compare:**

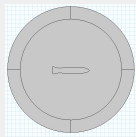
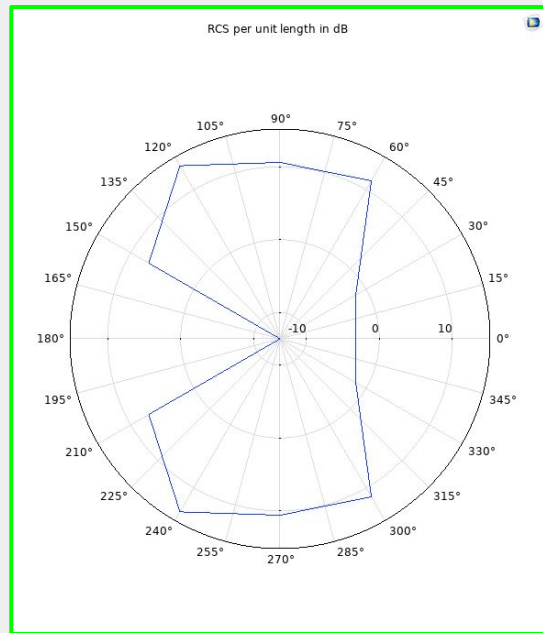


## Method 3: advanced model

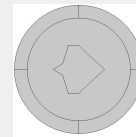
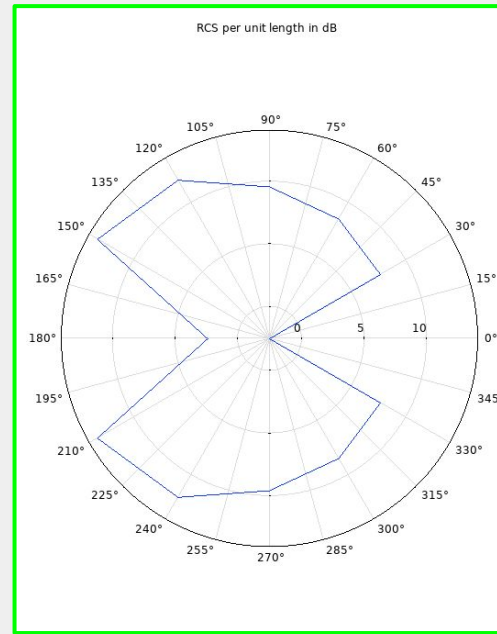
*Taking from the most successful models...*



Method 2  
model 2



Method 2  
model 3

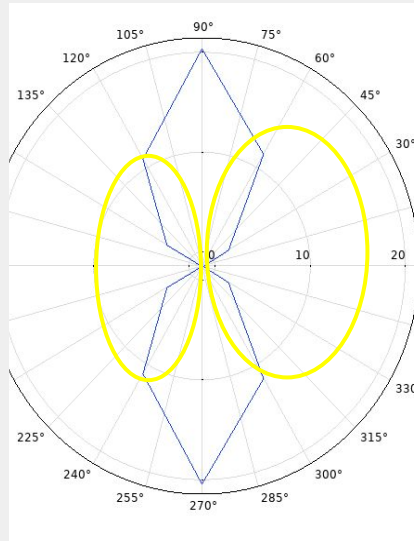
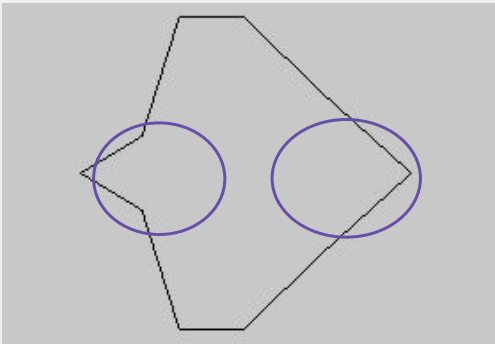
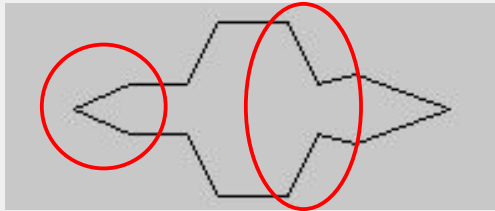


Method 2  
model 4

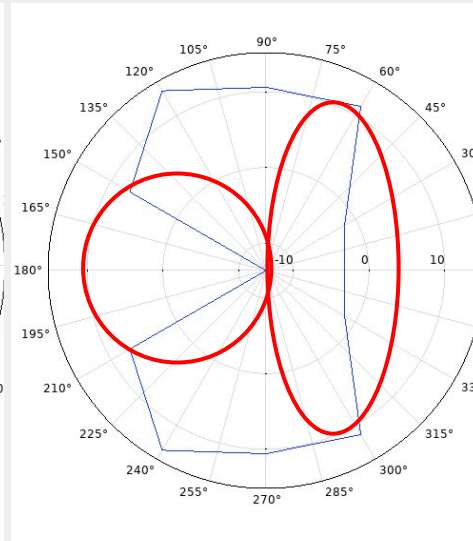


## Method 3: advanced model

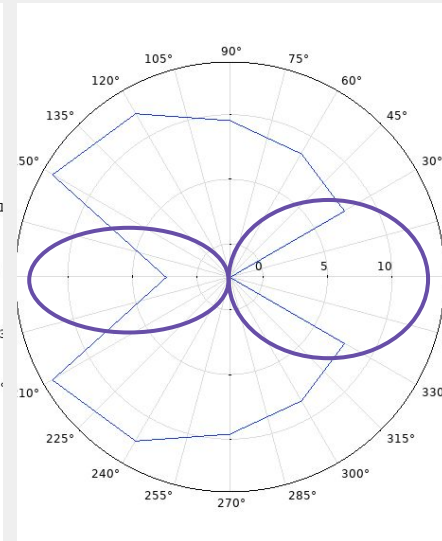
*Taking from the most successful models...*



Method 2  
model 2



Method 2  
model 3

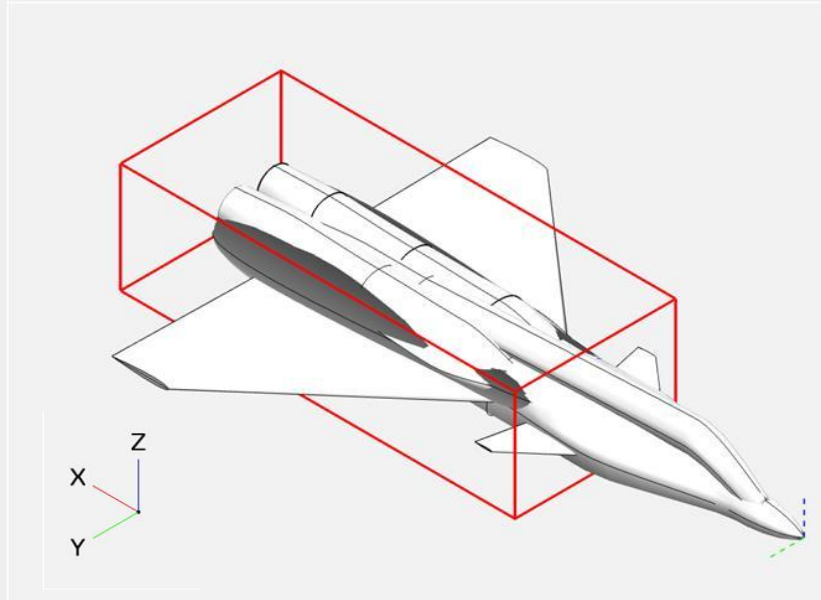


Method 2  
model 4

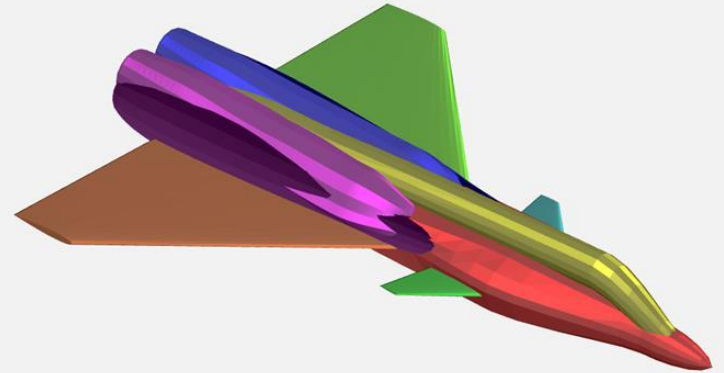
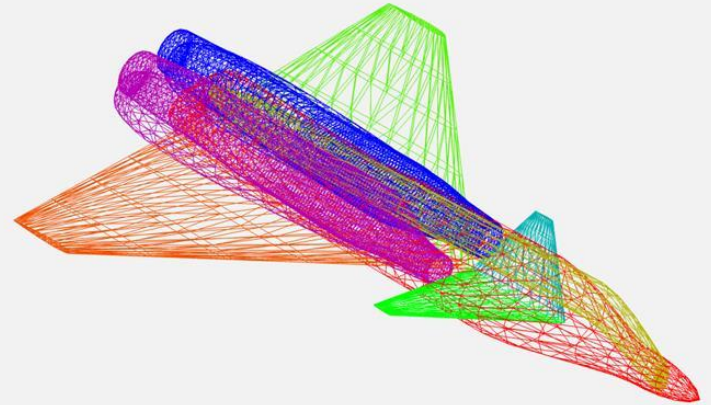


### Method 3: advanced 3D model

*3D paramaterized plane in OpenVSP*

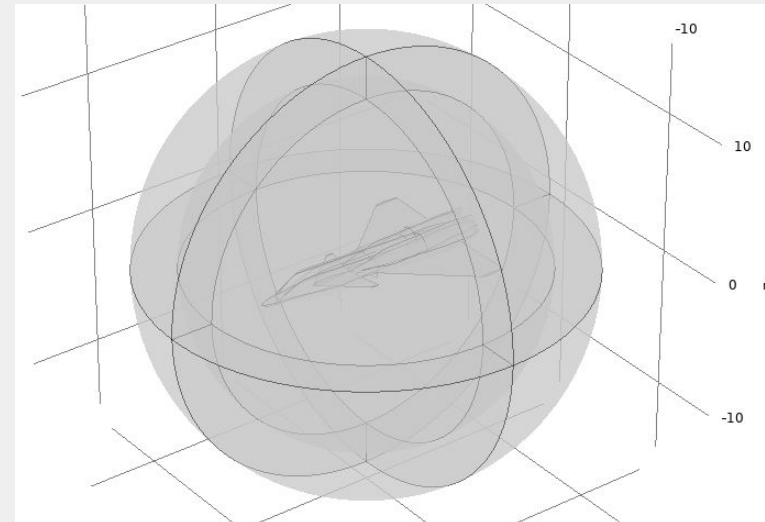
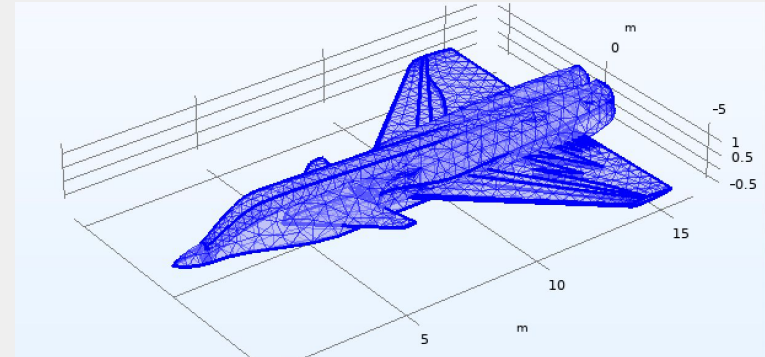
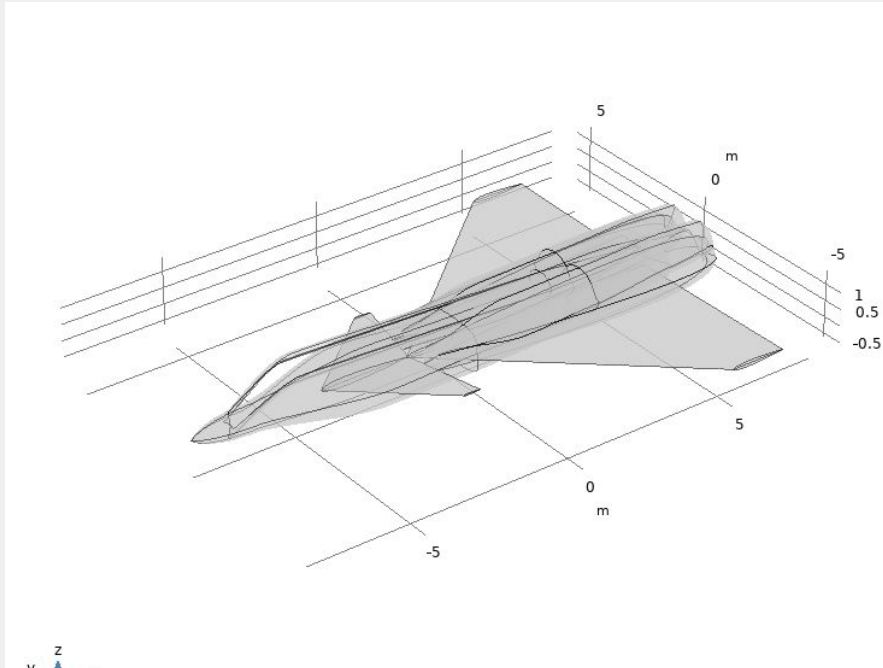


+ equipment considerations



## Method 3: advanced 3D model

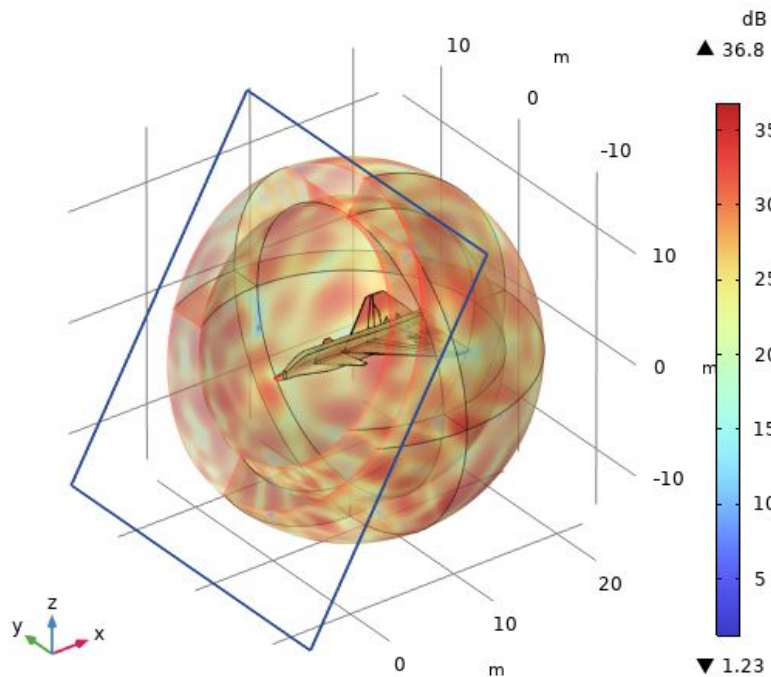
*3D paramaterized plane in COMSOL*



## Method 3: advanced 3D model

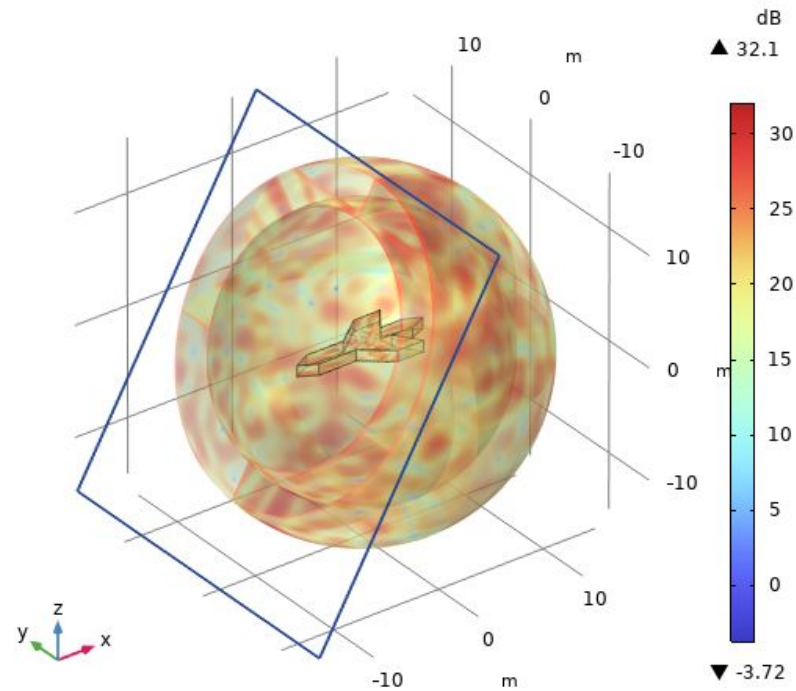
*Results: far-field norm*

freq=0.1 GHz, phi=1.5708 rad Far-field norm, dB (dB)



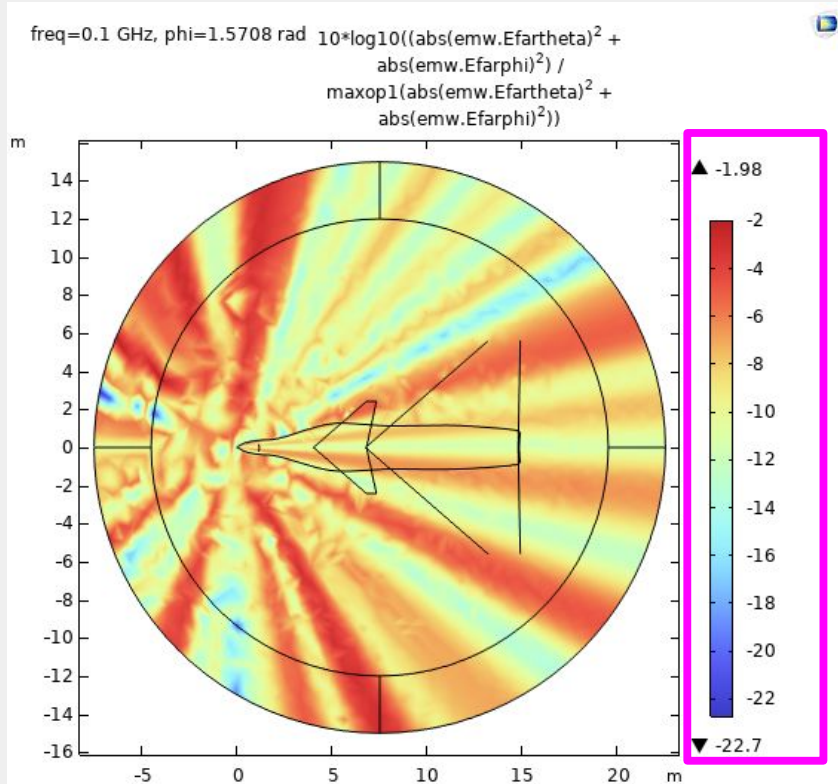
**Compare:**

freq=0.1 GHz, phi=1.5708 rad Far-field norm, dB (dB)

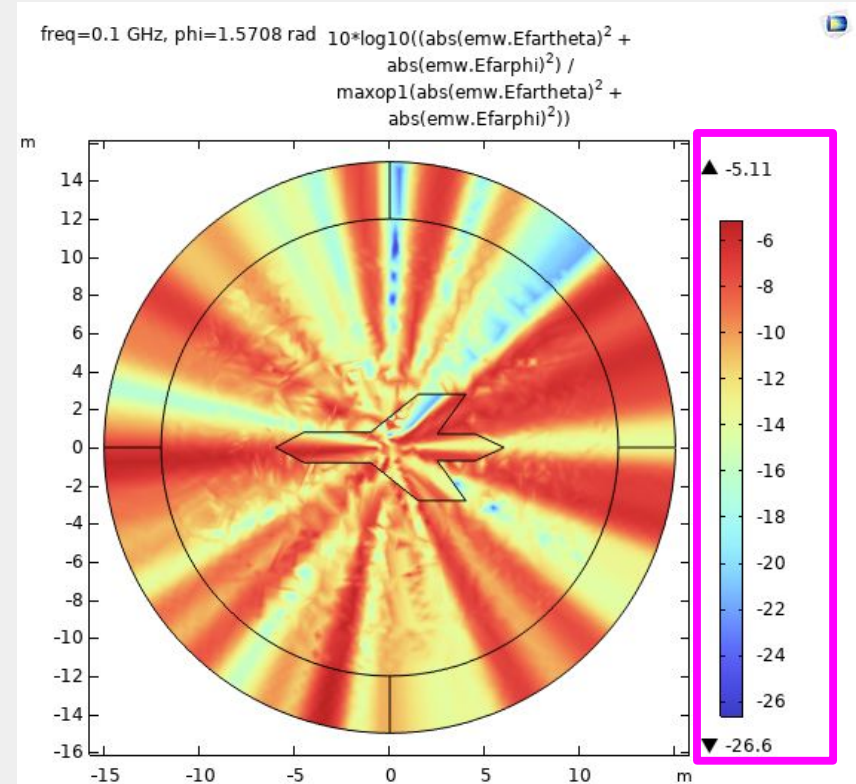


## Method 3: advanced 3D model

### Results: relative electric field

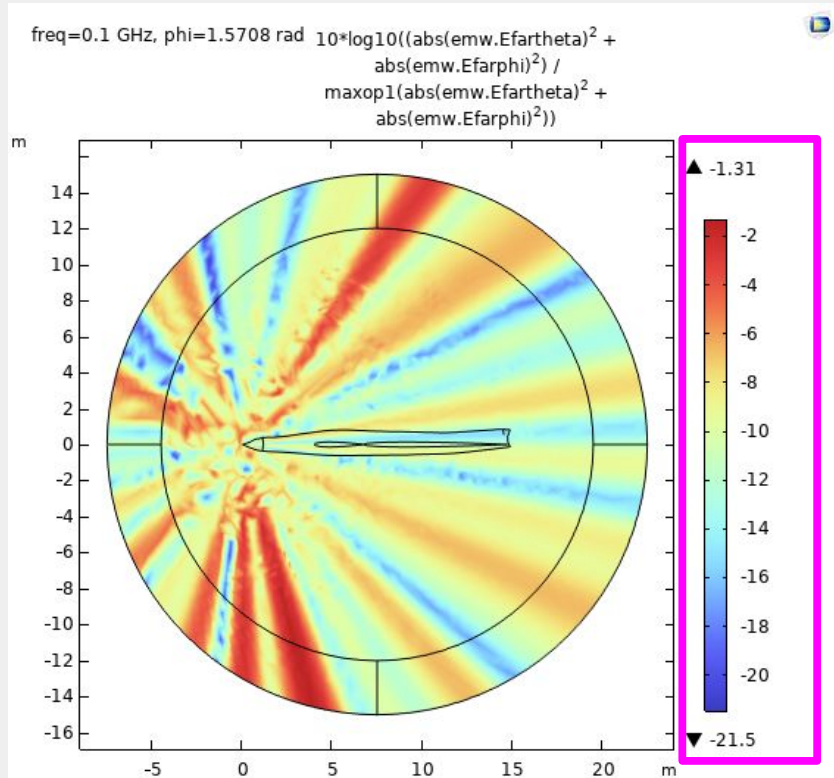


### Compare:

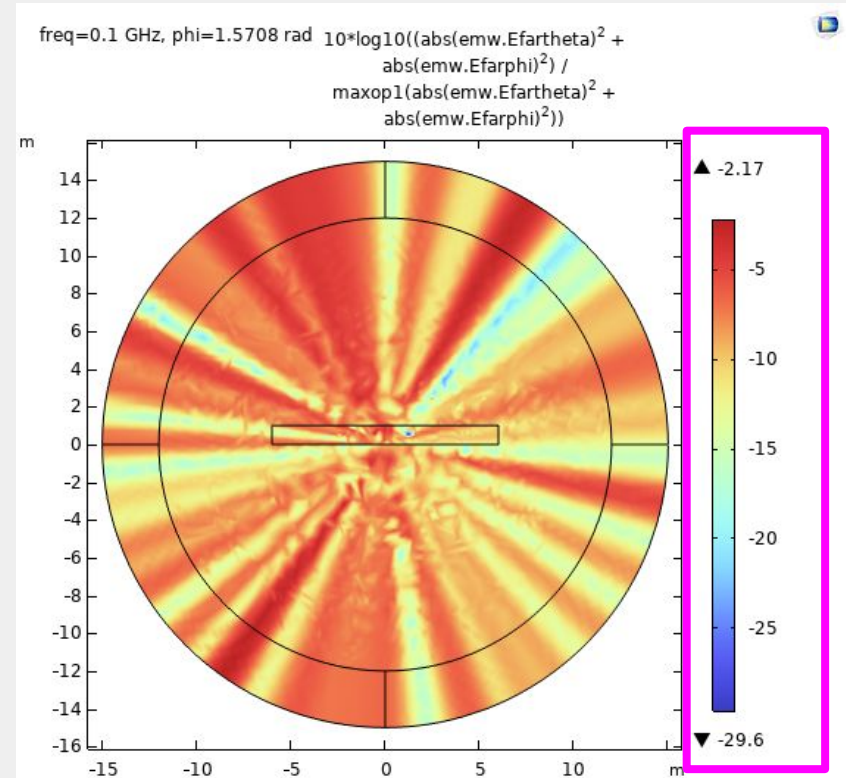


## Method 3: advanced 3D model

*Results: relative electric field*



**Compare:**





## Model Issues and Future Improvements

| Current Issues                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Future Improvements                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Geometry Mesh</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Difficult to refine for accurate results</li></ul> <p><b>Heavy Focus on 2D Computation</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Currently limited to single angular slice optimization of scattering</li></ul> <p><b>Complex Geometry Appear Identical</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Since geometry is constructed in 2D, many side profiles look identical</li></ul> | <p><b>Global 3D Optimization</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Allow for quantification over all relevant angles</li><li>- Identify full surface scattering trends and secondary sources</li></ul> <p><b>Parametric Optimization</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Automate surface fine tuning</li><li>- Allow for directional emphasis</li><li>- Introduce material optimization</li></ul> |